

Riftbound Core Rules

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000.	Golden and Silver Rules
001.	Golden Rule
002.	Card text supersedes rules text. Whenever a card fundamentally contradicts the rules, the card's indication is what is true.
050.	Silver Rule
051.	Card text uses different terminology than rules. Card text should be interpreted according to these rules, not as though it were text within these rules.
052.	Card , when written in card effects, is shorthand for " Main Deck card." Runes, legends, and battlefields are <i>not</i> considered cards when executing the abilities and effects of game objects. They are considered cards for the purposes of these rules.
053.	Cards refer to themselves in the first person.
053.1.	* Units and legends say "I," "me," etc.
053.2.	* Gear and spells say "this."
053.3.	* Battlefields say "here."
053.4.	* Cards may refer to themselves by their name for clarity. This is shorthand for the above terms.
054.	"Can't beats Can"
054.1.	Cards that forbid actions or effects, as a broad method of determination, supersede cards that allow or permit that same action or effect.
054.2.	If a card specifies that an action can "only" be performed under certain circumstances, it cannot be performed under any other circumstances.
055.	When executing card text, do as much as you can, ignoring impossible instructions.
055.1.	If all of a card's instructions are impossible, it is still played and resolved, but nothing happens.
056.	Cards a player owns may never be placed into a non-Board zone belonging to another player.
056.1.	Non-Board zones corresponding to a player include Main Deck, Rune Deck, Trash, Hand, Chosen Champion zone, and Banishment.
056.2.	If a card would enter such a zone, it goes to its owner's corresponding zone instead.
100.	Game Concepts
101.	Deck Construction
102.	<i>Riftbound</i> is a Trading Card Game where a player must provide their own cards to play against other players.
103.	To play <i>Riftbound</i> , a player must have a Main Deck , a Rune Deck , a Champion Legend , and a number of

	Battlefields determined by the Mode of Play . These are collectively referred to as a player's deck.
103.1.	1 Champion Legend
103.1.a.	This is placed in the Legend Zone at the start of the game.
103.1.b.	This will dictate the Domain Identity of the deck.
103.1.b.1.	Cards included in your deck must abide by your Domain Identity .
103.1.b.2.	Your deck's Domain Identity is dictated by the domains of your Champion Legend . In the default card frame, these domains appear as symbols in the legend's upper left corner.
103.1.b.3.	If a card has a single Domain , then that card is permitted in the Domain Identity that corresponds to the same Domain .
103.1.b.4.	If a card has more than one Domain , then that card is permitted <i>only</i> in a Domain Identity that contains all of the indicated Domains on that card.
103.1.b.5.	Some Game Effects may allow a player to add cards to their deck irrespective of those cards' Domains . Those cards are considered part of their deck's Domain Identity , regardless of their Domain .
103.2.	A Main Deck of at least 40 cards: A Chosen Champion Unit, as well as Units, Gear, and Spells
103.2.a.	Chosen Champion
103.2.a.1.	This will be placed in the Champion Zone at the start of the game.
103.2.a.2.	Must be a champion unit with a champion tag that matches the tag on your Champion Legend. <i>Example:</i> Loose Cannon has the tag <i>Jinx</i>. Therefore, a player could choose Jinx, Rebel or Jinx, Demolitionist as their Chosen Champion, because they also have the tag <i>Jinx</i>. <i>Example:</i> Tibbers has the tag <i>Annie</i>, but it is a signature unit, not a champion unit. It cannot be your Chosen Champion, even if your Champion Legend has the tag <i>Annie</i>.
103.2.a.3.	A player's Chosen Champion is both the specific card chosen for this slot during Deck Building and also any Champion Unit with the same name as the specific card selected for this specific slot during the course of play. <i>Example:</i> A player chose Jinx, Rebel as their Chosen Champion. One copy of Jinx, Rebel starts the game in their Chosen Champion zone. Any additional copies of Jinx, Rebel in their Main Deck, their hand, their trash, or on the board also count as their Chosen Champion for any game rules and effects that care about Chosen Champion status during the game.
103.2.b.	Your Main Deck can include up to 3 copies of the same named card.
103.2.b.1.	This includes your Chosen Champion. <i>Example:</i> A deck could include Volibear, Furious as its Chosen Champion and still include 2 more copies of Volibear, Furious in their Main Deck.
103.2.b.2.	Cards have different names even if they represent the same character. <i>Example:</i> A deck could include 3 copies of Yasuo, Remorseful and 3 copies of Yasuo, Windrider, because they have different names.
103.2.c.	Subject to Domain Identity .

103.2.d.	Your deck may only contain 3 <i>total</i> Signature cards that have the same Champion tag as your Champion Legend .
103.2.d.1.	Regardless of name, a deck may only contain a sum total of 3 Signature cards.
103.2.d.2.	All of the Signature cards must have the Champion tag that corresponds to the Champion Legend of the deck.
103.2.d.3.	Signature cards are not Champion units and cannot be placed in the Champion Zone .
103.2.e.	Subject to card legality of the Format being played.
103.3.	Rune Deck
103.3.a.	12 Rune Cards
103.3.a.1.	Cards in the Rune Deck must be of the Domain Identity of your Champion Legend .
103.3.b.	Must be shuffled and kept separate from the Main Deck .
103.4.	Battlefields
103.4.a.	The number will be dictated by your Mode of Play .
103.4.b.	Subject to Domain Identity if applicable.
103.4.c.	Cannot include more than one of a Battlefield of the same name when there are more than one required for the deck.
104.	Setup
105.	Spaces
106.	The Play Area is a collection of logical Zones that are defined by their behaviors and relationships to Players . These Zones are grouped into The Board and Non-Board Zones .
107.	The Board
107.1.	Bases
107.1.a.	Each player has their own Base .
107.1.b.	Each Base is a Location . <i>See rule 197. Locations for more information.</i>
107.1.c.	Permanents and Runes controlled by a player reside in that player's Base .
107.1.c.1.	Permanents attached to Permanents controlled by a player may also be found in that player's Base , regardless of their controller.
107.1.d.	Permanents and Runes in Bases are Public Information .
107.2.	Battlefield Zone
107.2.a.	The Battlefield Zone houses multiple Battlefields .
107.2.b.	Each Battlefield is individually a Location . <i>See rule 197. Locations for more information.</i>
107.2.c.	Battlefields and permanents at Battlefields are Public Information .

107.3.	Facedown Zones
107.3.a.	Each Battlefield is associated with a sub-zone called a Facedown Zone , a single logical space that a card can be put facedown in through various Game Effects .
107.3.b.	Each Facedown Zone has a maximum occupancy of one card.
107.3.b.1.	The maximum occupancy of a Facedown Zone can increase or decrease.
107.3.b.2.	If the maximum occupancy of a Facedown Zone decreases to a number less than the number of cards currently located there, the controller of that Facedown Zone must put a number of cards equal to the difference in the trash from the Facedown Zone .
107.3.c.	Cards can only be placed in or occupy the Facedown Zone if the controller of the card also controls the associated Battlefield .
107.3.d.	If a player loses Control of a Battlefield , any cards in the Facedown Zone associated with that Battlefield are removed during the next Cleanup . <i>See rule 318. Cleanups for more information.</i> <i>See rule 421. Hide for more information.</i>
107.3.e.	Facedown Zones are not locations.
107.3.f.	Facedown Zones are Public Zones , though facedown cards located there are Private .
107.4.	Legend Zone
107.4.a.	The space for each player's Champion Legend .
107.4.b.	This is not a location.
107.4.c.	The Champion Legend here is a Game Object . <i>See rule 119. Game Objects for more information.</i>
107.4.d.	The Champion Legend cannot be removed, moved, or displaced from this zone.
107.4.d.1.	Some effects may add a legend card or token to the Legend Zone . These legends are not Champion Legends.
107.4.d.2.	Non-Champion legends may be removed from the Legend Zone. They cannot exist in any zone other than the Legend Zone or Banishment .
108.	Non-Board Zones
108.1.	The Chain
108.1.a.	Cards and abilities are placed here as part of the process of being played . <i>See rule 327. Chains for more information.</i>
108.1.b.	Cards and abilities on the Chain are Public Information .
108.2.	Trashes
108.2.a.	Each player has their own Trash .
108.2.b.	This space is where cards are placed when they are killed or discarded, when they finish being executed as spells, when they are moved to the trash as an effect, etc.
108.2.c.	Cards in each player's Trash are unordered . Their sequence does not matter, and they may be reorganized.

108.2.d.	Cards in a player's Trash are Public Information . <i>See rule 128. Privacy for more information.</i>
108.3.	Champion Zones
108.3.a.	Each player has their own Champion Zone .
108.3.b.	The space each player puts their Chosen Champion at the start of the game.
108.3.c.	The Chosen Champion cannot be returned to this zone by normal means.
108.3.c.1.	If a Chosen Champion is instructed to be returned to this zone, it can only do so if there is not a card already in this zone.
108.3.d.	The Chosen Champion can be played from here as normal, following the rules of Playing a Card . <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.</i>
108.3.e.	Cards in a player's Champion Zone are Public Information .
108.4.	Main Deck Zones
108.4.a.	Each player has their own Main Deck Zone .
108.4.b.	The space for the player's Main Deck .
108.4.c.	Primarily houses the face-down Main Deck during gameplay.
108.4.d.	The order of cards in the Main Deck is Secret Information during the course of play. <i>See rule 128. Privacy for more information.</i>
108.5.	Rune Deck Zones
108.5.a.	Each player has their own Rune Deck Zone .
108.5.b.	The space for the player's Rune Deck .
108.5.c.	Primarily houses the face-down runes during gameplay.
108.5.d.	The order of runes in the Rune Deck is Secret Information during the course of play. <i>See rule 128. Privacy for more information.</i>
108.6.	Banishments
108.6.a.	Each player has their own Banishment .
108.6.b.	This space is where cards are placed when they are banished by a spell or effect.
108.6.c.	Represents cards that have been removed from play in a more difficult-to-recover way, or a temporary space to hold cards while effects are being processed.
108.6.d.	The cards in the banishment are unordered . Their sequence does not matter, and they may be reorganized.
108.6.e.	The cards in any player's Banishment are Public Information . <i>See rule 128. Privacy for more information.</i>
108.7.	The Hand
108.7.a.	Each player has their own Hand .
108.7.b.	This is the location cards go when Drawn .

108.7.c.	The cards in a player's hand are Private Information .
108.7.d.	The cards in a player's hand are Unordered . Their sequence does not matter and they may be reorganized.
108.7.e.	The number of cards in a player's hand is Public Information .
108.7.f.	The hand can be targeted as a zone, and cards there can be affected by spells and effects when specified.
109.	All Game Objects in the collective Play Areas are Public Information .
109.1.	Any player may view, or be provided with the details of the face-up information printed on the cards in the Play Area .
109.2.	The State of all Game Objects in the Play Area is also Public Information . <i>Examples:</i> If a Unit is Buffed If a Gear is Exhausted Etc.
110.	Setup Process
111.	Each player separates their Champion Legend and places it in the Legend Zone .
112.	Each player separates their Chosen Champion and places it in the Champion Zone .
113.	Each player sets aside their Battlefields .
113.1.	Your Mode of Play will dictate how these are used and placed into the Battlefield Zone . <i>See rule 481. Modes of Play for more information.</i>
114.	Each player shuffles their Main and Rune Decks , separately, then places them into their respective Zones.
114.1.	The Main Deck is placed in the Main Deck Zone .
114.2.	The Rune Deck is placed in the Rune Deck Zone .
115.	Determine Turn Order using any fair random method agreed on by all players.
115.1.	Turn Order is established as a repeating set of the players.
115.1.a.	The Mode of Play will specify how to determine a First Player .
115.1.b.	If not otherwise specified, Seating then determines the sequence, play proceeding clockwise from the First Player .
115.1.b.1.	The First Player is the player who becomes the Turn Player first.
115.1.c.	The Turn Order generates a looping queue of turns, starting with the First Player and repeating until the game ends.
115.2.	See the selected Mode of Play for any adjustments to each player's first turn. <i>See rule 481. Modes of Play for more information.</i>
116.	Players each draw 4.
117.	In turn order, players perform their Mulligan .
117.1.	A player may choose up to two cards in their hand. They set those cards aside.
117.2.	Then, that player draws as many cards as they set aside.

117.3.	Finally, that player Recycles the cards that were set aside. <i>See rule 416. Recycle for more information.</i>
118.	Begin play with the First Player taking their turn.
119.	Game Objects
120.	A Game Object is any game piece that can produce one or more Game Effects or grant prerequisites for players to take Game Actions .
121.	A Game Object does not include nor preclude any inherent properties beyond the ability to produce, or act as the prerequisite for, Game Effects and Game Actions .
122.	A Game Object can be a literal object or a logical object.
123.	Game Objects include, but are not limited to, the following: Main Deck cards in any zone Runes in any zone Legends Battlefields Tokens in any zone Abilities of any type on the chain Counters and other status markers
124.	A Game Object that changes zones to or from a Non-Board Zone becomes a new object for the purposes of tracking that object.
124.1.	Whenever a Game Object changes zones to or from a Non-Board Zone , all Temporary Modifications of all kinds cease to be tracked on it in all capacities. <i>Examples:</i> Damage is cleared. Counters are removed. Granted Keywords are no longer granted. Statuses are cleared.
124.2.	A Game Object can have any of the following statuses (non-exhaustive): Attached, Attacking, Buffed, Banished, Controlled, Defending, Empowered, Equipped, Exhausted, Facedown, Readied, Replaced, Revealed, Stunned, and any applied Layer alternations.
125.	Cards
126.	<i>Riftbound</i> games are composed of players playing the cards in their respective decks.
127.	Ownership
127.1.	For gameplay purposes, a card's Owner is the player who brought it into the game, either as their Champion Legend , one of their Battlefields , as part of their Main Deck or Rune Deck , or Created during the process of play. The legal owner of a card doesn't matter during gameplay. <i>Example:</i> Bo didn't bring a deck, so Alice loans him a deck. During the game, Bo is considered the owner of those cards, even though legally they belong to Alice.
128.	Privacy
128.1.	A card will always exist in one of the many Zones described during Setup .
128.2.	A card will have a different level of Privacy based on its state or where it resides at a given time.
128.2.a.	Unless specified otherwise by the state of the card, a card's Privacy is the same as the zone it is located in.

128.3.	Secret: This level of Privacy indicates that no player may read or look at the face of the card.
128.4.	Private: This level of Privacy indicates that only the controller of a card on the board or the owner of a card in any other zone may read or look at the face of the card. <i>Example:</i> Cards in a player's hand are owned by that player. Only that player may read or look at their faces. <i>Example:</i> If a player controls a facedown card at a battlefield, that player and only that player may read or look at that card's face, regardless of who owns that card.
128.5.	Public: This level of Privacy indicates that any player may read or look at the face of the card.
128.6.	A player cannot be compelled to perform an action on cards whose privacy is secret or private if that action specifies a type or quality of card. <i>Example:</i> A card effect reads, "Play a unit from your hand, ignoring its costs." Although the effect does not say "may", the player can choose not to perform the action even if they have a unit in their hand, because the effect specifies a card type.
128.6.a.	If an effect would compel a player to perform an action on cards whose privacy is secret or private, and if that effect specifies a type or quality of card, the player in question may choose to ignore that instruction. Ignored instructions are deemed impossible.
129.	Back Side
129.1.	The back side of a card is the side with the Riftbound logo.
129.2.	There is a unique pattern of back side for each of the three categories of card: Main Deck cards, Rune Deck cards, and Battlefields and Champion Legends .
129.3.	The back side of a card is presented to conceal information for Private and Secret information cards. For example, cards in the Main Deck and cards in hand have their back side presented.
129.4.	The term facedown is used to describe the state during regular play of having a card's back side presented on the Board. A facedown card's front side is considered Private Information .
130.	Front Side
130.1.	The front side of a card is the opposite of its back.
130.2.	This is also referred to as a front face .
130.3.	This can be identified in situations where the back is not easily discernible by the presence of the Play Cost in the upper left corner of the card.
130.4.	Cards, when played, are played with their front face presented.
130.5.	The term face up is used to describe the state during regular play of having a card's front face presented
130.6.	Cards are considered to be Public Information while in this state, even if obscured by other cards in a pile. <i>Example:</i> The Trash is Public Information because all cards there have their front face presented even while stacked.
131.	Cost
131.1.	Main Deck cards have a Cost, listed in the upper left corner of the front face of the card. <i>See rule 165. Rune Pools for more information.</i>
131.2.	Energy Cost
131.2.a.	The numeral listed in the Cost element in the upper left corner of the card.

131.3.	Power cost
131.3.a.	The symbols, listed vertically, in the Cost element in the upper left corner of the card.
131.3.b.	This section may not be present on every card.
132.	Name
132.1.	Each card has a name that identifies it uniquely.
132.2.	This is usually located in the middle of the card.
132.3.	Cards that are printed in different languages but represent the same card are considered to have the same name for the purposes of deckbuilding and gameplay. <i>Example:</i> Chemtech Enforcer in English and its counterpart in Chinese are considered the same card, despite the Name element on the card reading differently.
132.4.	Some cards have both a short name and a subtitle. For all purposes, including rules and deckbuilding, such a card's name is "[Short Name], [Subtitle]". <i>Example:</i> Kai'Sa, Evolutionary and Kai'Sa, Survivor both have the short name Kai'Sa, but they have different names. You can include 3 of each in your deck under normal deckbuilding rules. If one of them is your Chosen Champion, the other is not.
133.	Category
133.1.	A card can have one or more Categories and Sub-Categories based on the properties of its front and back sides.
133.2.	These Categories and Sub-Categories dictate the behaviors of the card during play.
133.3.	Spells and other effects can refer to categories, sub-categories, supertypes, card types, tags, and other characteristics inclusively or exclusively. <i>Example:</i> A "non-unit card" is any card that is not a unit. <i>Example:</i> A "unit" is any game object that is a unit, regardless of any other categories it belongs to.
133.4.	Main Deck Cards begin the game in the Main Deck or (in the case of a Chosen Champion) the Champion Zone .
133.4.a.	Permanents
133.4.a.1.	An umbrella sub-category encompassing Main Deck Game Objects that remain on the board after being played.
133.4.a.2.	Unit and Gear are permanent types.
133.4.b.	Spells
133.4.b.1.	A sub-category encompassing Main Deck cards with the spell type, which do not remain on the board after being played.
133.5.	Rune Deck Cards begin the game in the Rune Deck .
133.5.a.	Runes
133.5.a.1.	A sub-category encompassing cards with the rune type. These are channeled rather than played. They remain on the board after being channeled, but they are <i>not</i> permanents, as they are not Main Deck cards.
133.6.	Other Cards are not part of either the Main or Rune Decks and begin the game in a zone determined by their type.

133.6.a.	Battlefields
133.6.a.1.	A sub-category encompassing cards with the battlefield type. They are not played or channeled. They start the game on the board.
133.6.b.	Legends
133.6.b.1.	A sub-category encompassing cards with the legend type. They are not played or channeled. They start the game in the Legend Zone and cannot typically leave it during play.
133.7.	Supertypes are Categories that may apply to game objects of multiple types. They are listed before a card's type.
133.7.a.	Champion is a supertype that applies exclusively to units. It impacts the rules for deckbuilding. <i>See rule 103.2.a. Chosen Champion for more information.</i>
133.7.b.	Signature is a supertype that may apply to game objects of any card type. It impacts the rules for deckbuilding. <i>See rule 103.2.d. for more information about Signature cards.</i>
133.8.	Tags are Categories that may apply to game objects of multiple types. They are listed after a card's type.
133.8.a.	Tags have no innate rules meaning, but may be referenced by game rules and card effects.
133.8.b.	Tags used to link Legends , Champion Units , and Signature cards are known as Champion Tags .
134.	Domain
134.1.	Most cards belong to one or more of six Domains , identified by one or more symbols in the lower right corner.
134.2.	Each Domain has an associated color, a unique symbol, and a shorthand used to represent that symbol in written text.
134.2.a.	Fury is associated with the color red and represented by a circular symbol with three projecting points. Its shorthand is [R].
134.2.b.	Calm is associated with the color green and represented by a symbol resembling a leaf. Its shorthand is [G].
134.2.c.	Mind is associated with the color blue and represented by a symbol resembling a sun and moon. Its shorthand is [B].
134.2.d.	Body is associated with the color orange and represented by a blocky diamond-shaped symbol. Its shorthand is [O].
134.2.e.	Chaos is associated with the color purple and represented by a hexagonal symbol with swirls emanating from its center. Its shorthand is [P].
134.2.f.	Order is associated with the color yellow and represented by an angular winged symbol. Its shorthand is [Y].
135.	Rules Text
135.1.	All cards have a section that describes how they affect the game. This section is known as the Rules Text of the card.

135.2.	This section may contain:
135.2.a.	Abilities
135.2.a.1.	Abilities are discrete pieces of text that describe what a card may or must do. <i>See rule 360. Abilities for more information.</i>
135.2.a.2.	They may appear on any card.
135.2.b.	Instructions
135.2.b.1.	Instructions are a type of text that appears on spells and within abilities.
135.2.b.2.	They describe actions to be performed by one or more players.
135.2.b.3.	Instructions will self-describe when they are to be executed. If there is no timing described, they will execute during resolution. <i>Example:</i> An instruction says “as you play me, kill a unit as an additional cost.” That instruction will execute as the card is being played. If the card is given Repeat and the Repeat cost is paid, this instruction will not execute because the Repeat execution does not happen until resolution of the spell, after this instruction has executed.
135.2.b.4.	Instructions can usually be recognized by the way they are written. An instruction is written in the imperative mood, using the base form of a verb and omitting the subject unless necessary.
135.2.b.5.	A single instruction is made up of a game action and its complement.
135.2.b.5.a.	The complement of a game action is made up of the players or Game Objects that perform that game action, that that game action is performed on, the condition under which it is performed, and the duration for its effect to last. Some game actions omit a complement entirely. <i>Example:</i> Void Seeker is made up of two instructions. The first is “deal 4 to a unit at a battlefield.” Here “deal 4” is the game action, while “a unit at a battlefield,” is its complement. The second instruction, “draw 1,” has no complement. <i>Example:</i> Teemo, Strategist’s defend trigger reads “When I defend, choose an enemy unit here and reveal the top 5 cards of your Main Deck. Deal 1 to that unit for each card with Hidden revealed this way, then recycle the revealed cards.” There are four instructions here: “choose an enemy unit here,” “reveal the top 5 cards of your Main Deck,” “deal 1 to that unit for each card with Hidden revealed this way,” and “recycle the revealed cards.”
135.2.b.6.	Instructions do not include trigger conditions or the events or actions that a replacement effect defines as being eligible to be replaced. <i>Example:</i> An ability reads “When you play me, draw 1.” The trigger condition for this ability is not an instruction. “Draw 1,” is the only instruction included in the ability. <i>Example:</i> An ability reads “If a unit would die, banish it instead.” The text “If a unit would die,” is not an instruction of the ability. <i>Example:</i> An ability reads “As I’m revealed from your Main Deck, Add [2].” The text “As I’m revealed from your Main Deck,” is not an instruction of the ability.
135.2.c.	Keywords

135.2.c.1.	Keywords are short words or phrases that represent longer abilities or instructions. <i>See rule 800. Keywords for more information.</i>
135.2.c.2.	Keywords may or may not have reminder text.
135.2.d.	Reminder Text
135.2.d.1.	Reminder text appears in italics and parentheses.
135.2.d.2.	Its purpose is to summarize relevant rules, including keywords and other rules.
135.2.d.3.	The presence, absence, or exact wording of reminder text has no effect on game function.
135.2.e.	Symbols
135.2.e.1.	Rules text sometimes contains symbols that express game concepts. Each symbol also has a shorthand used to represent it in written text.
135.2.e.2.	The cost of Exhausting a Permanent is represented by the “exhaust symbol,” which resembles a card turning sideways. Its shorthand is [E]. (Some previous rules information has given its shorthand as [T].)
135.2.e.3.	Might is represented by the “Might symbol,” which resembles a sword and shield. Its shorthand is [M]. (Some previous rules information has given its shorthand as [S].)
135.2.e.4.	Power of a specific Domain is represented by its domain symbol and the corresponding shorthand. <i>See rule 134. Domain for more information.</i>
135.2.e.5.	Power of any Domain is represented by a swirling rainbow symbol. Its shorthand is [A].
135.2.e.5.a.	When required as a cost, [A] can be paid by Power of any Domain .
135.2.e.5.b.	When Added to a player’s Rune Pool , [A] can be spent to pay a Power cost of any Domain .
135.2.e.6.	Power of a domain corresponding to a card’s own Domain is not represented by a symbol, but appears in these rules similarly to other symbols. Its shorthand is [C].
135.2.e.6.a.	When a [C] shorthand is printed on a card as reminder text, it assumes that card’s usual Domain , but it still means “one Power of this card’s Domain .”
135.2.e.6.b.	A [C] shorthand on a card with no Domain is processed as [A] instead.
135.2.e.6.c.	A [C] shorthand on a card with multiple Domains is processed as any power of that card’s Domains . <i>Example:</i> Defiant Dance is a Calm and Chaos spell. Its cost is [1][C]. The power component of that cost can be paid with either [G] or [P]. <i>Example:</i> Tibbers is a Fury and Chaos Unit. If Tibbers is granted the Accelerate keyword, the power component of the optional additional cost can be paid with either [R] or [P].
135.2.e.7.	A keyword associated with an ability is indicated by the [>] symbol.
135.2.e.7.a.	This could be a dependent keyword like [Legion][>] or [Level][>], a

		triggered ability with a keyworded trigger condition like [Deathknell] or it could be a permissive keyword associated with an ability like [Action][>] or [Reaction][>].
135.2.e.7.b.		Whatever instruction or ability comes after the [>] is modified by the keyword that comes before the [>]. It will either be inactive, in the case of a dependent keyword; the trigger effect, in the case of a keyword triggered ability; or it will receive the permission granted by the keyword in the case of a permissive keyword.
135.3.	Rules text can be blank.	
135.4.	A card's printed Rules Text is Inactive while that card is Attached to another card. <i>See rule 716. Attachment for more information.</i> <i>See rule 720. Inactive for more information.</i>	
135.4.a.	The presence of text, rules, Keywords , and other effects can still be referenced and detected by other game effects, even while Rules Text is Inactive .	
135.4.b.	Any granted or appended Rules Text on a card is still Active even if that card is Attached to another card.	
136.	Effect Text	
136.1.	Some cards have a separate section of text below the Rules Text . This is referred to as the Effect Text .	
136.2.	Effect Text can contain additional Abilities .	
136.2.a.	Effect Text can be blank.	
136.2.b.	Effect Text is inactive unless the card with the Effect Text is Attached to another card. <i>See rule 716. Attachment for more information.</i> <i>See rule 720. Inactive for more information.</i>	
136.2.c.	The abilities in the Effect Text section of a card are appended to the Rules Text of the card to which the card with the Effect Text is Attached .	
136.2.d.	Effect Text may refer to “this” or to the name of the Attached game object that appended the Effect Text . Doing so refers to the Attached game object and not the Top-Most Card , even if the Top-Most Card shares a name with the Attached game object. <i>Example:</i> Guardian Angel's effect text reads “If I would die, kill Guardian Angel instead. Heal me, exhaust me, and recall me.” <i>Example:</i> Brutalizer's effect text reads “If this was attached to me this turn, I have an additional +2 [M].” The “this” in the effect text refers to the attached Brutalizer.	
137.	Might Bonus	
137.1.	Some cards have a Might Bonus in their lower right corner, expressed as an operator plus an integer.	
137.2.	A card's Might Bonus can be +0 .	
137.3.	A card's Might Bonus modulates the Might of the card to which the card that has the Might Bonus is Attached . <i>See rule 716. Attachment for more information.</i>	
137.3.a.	The Might Bonus is applied while Attached and stops applying as soon as the card with the Might Bonus is no longer Attached .	
137.3.b.	If the card to which a card with a Might Bonus is Attached has no Might value, the Might Bonus is ignored.	

138.	Flavor Text
138.1.	Flavor text is text that appears at the bottom of some cards to provide aesthetic enjoyment. It conveys no gameplay information. <i>Example:</i> The card Void Seeker features a quote from the character Kai'Sa. It does not have the Kai'Sa tag and has no gameplay connection to the Champion unit Kai'Sa.
138.2.	Flavor text is located at the bottom of the section provided for rules text, usually in a shaded bar. It appears in italics.
139.	Illustration
139.1.	Each card has an illustration. It conveys no gameplay information.
140.	Units
141.	Unit is:
141.1.	A Game Object
141.1.a.	While on the Board :
141.1.a.1.	Units are at one of several Locations while on the Board : a Battlefield or their Base .
141.1.a.2.	Units and their details are Public Information while on the Board .
141.1.a.3.	Units can be chosen, affected, or manipulated by spells, affects, or game actions that specify Units .
141.1.a.4.	Units can be Killed. See rule 428. Kill for more information.
141.1.b.	While in the Trash :
141.1.b.1.	Units are treated as Cards , similar to when in the Hand .
141.1.b.2.	They retain the properties of being a Unit , but are not on the Board and thus cannot take actions or be affected by spells, abilities, or game actions that target Units on the Board .
141.1.b.3.	Units can be affected by spells and game effects that target Units in the Trash .
141.2.	A Card Type
141.2.a.	This is a unique identifier that some spells or abilities will use to restrict what they can choose or affect.
141.2.b.	The card type is relevant in all zones.
142.	Damage is a marked value that is applied to Units .
142.1.	Damage is not a Game Object .
142.2.	Damage is a value tracked per-Unit.
142.3.	Damage is marked on Units by players.
142.3.a.	The player responsible for the Deal action that caused the Damage to be marked is the player who marked that Damage .
142.3.b.	Game Effects may refer to that player's Damage . This means the Damage marked by that

	player. <i>Example:</i> A unit reads in part “Your damage can’t be prevented.” This refers to the damage marked by that player.
142.4.	Damage tracks how close a Unit is to being Killed. See rule 428. Kill for more information.
142.4.a.	Lethal Damage is the amount of marked Damage that will cause a unit to die in a cleanup.
142.4.b.	Lethal Damage for a Unit is a non-zero amount greater than or equal to that Unit's Might. <i>Example:</i> A unit has 5 [M] and 3 damage marked on it. Frigid Touch is played targeting that unit. When it resolves, the unit's Might becomes 3, and it will have lethal damage marked on it. <i>Example:</i> A unit has 0 [M]. In order to have lethal damage marked on it, it must have at least 1 damage marked on it.
142.4.c.	Some effects may alter this amount. These effects will refer to the amount of damage needed to kill a unit. <i>Example:</i> Elder Dragon's passive ability reads “Any amount of your damage is enough to kill enemy units.” This alters the Lethal Damage value for enemy units that have damage marked by you.
142.5.	Damage can be Healed. See rule 418. Heal for more information.
143.	Units have multiple Intrinsic Properties unique to them:
143.1.	Tag: A Unit has zero or more Tags representing one or more champions, regions, factions, or species it belongs to.
143.1.a.	These have no intrinsic rules or behaviors by themselves.
143.1.b.	Spells, abilities, and game actions can reference these types as part of their execution.
143.2.	Might: The combat statistic of a Unit. Used to determine a Unit's contribution to Combat, as well as when it is Killed by damaging effects.
143.2.a.	If a Unit ever has nonzero damage marked on it equalling or exceeding its Might, it is Killed.
143.2.b.	If a unit's Might is ever less than 0, it is treated as 0 when referenced by spells and abilities, and when summing Might to be assigned as damage in the Combat Damage Step. See rule 465. The Combat Damage Step for more information.
143.2.b.1.	Although the unit's Might is treated as 0, it is not 0. Effects that calculate Might increases and decreases use the actual value of the unit's Might.
143.3.	Units can have damage marked on them.
143.3.a.	When spells, abilities, or other game effects deal damage, Units mark that damage on them temporarily. This can be tracked with coins, dice, or other markers, or by memory.
143.3.b.	Damage is Healed from Units at two specific times:
143.3.b.1.	At the end of each player's turn. See rule 317.2. Ending Phase for more information.
143.3.b.2.	During a Combat Cleanup. See rule 466.1. for more information about Combat Cleanups.
143.4.	Units enter the Board exhausted.

143.4.a.	This can be altered by Accelerate or similar game effects. <i>See rule 805. Accelerate for more information.</i>
144.	Units have the Inherent Ability to perform a Standard Move .
144.1.	This action is limited in when it can be performed.
144.1.a.	This action can be done any time during a player's Main Phase .
144.1.b.	This action cannot be performed during a Closed State .
144.1.c.	This action cannot be performed during a Showdown or Combat .
144.2.	Exhausting the Unit is the Cost for this action.
144.3.	Players may perform multiple Units' standard move simultaneously. This is treated as one game action performed on multiple Units .
144.3.a.	When a Move like this is declared by a player, the units' Destination must be the same.
144.3.b.	When a Move like this is declared by a player, the Origins do not need to be the same.
144.3.c.	The Costs of Exhausting the Units are also paid Simultaneously .
144.4.	The Destinations where Units can Move to with their Standard Move are restricted:
144.4.a.	Units may move from their Base to a Battlefield .
144.4.a.1.	Units cannot Move to a Battlefield that already has units from 2 other players present, or where a Combat is ongoing that has 2 other players as participants. <i>See rule 447.2. For more information on valid destinations for movement.</i>
144.4.b.	Units may move from a Battlefield to their Base .
144.4.c.	Ganking is a unique ability that affects a Unit's Standard Move
144.4.c.1.	Units with Ganking may use their Standard Move to Move from Battlefield to Battlefield . <i>See rule 810. Ganking for more information.</i>
145.	Units may have Activated Abilities .
145.1.	Activated Abilities are Game Effects that are written as Costs followed by a ":", and then succeeded by an effect. <i>See rule 376. Activated Abilities for more information.</i>
145.2.	The Activated Ability of Units may be executed at any time during the controlling player's Main Phase during an Open State , and not during a Showdown .
145.2.a.	This follows the same process as playing a card. <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.</i>
145.2.a.1.	This behaves, once activated, like a spell without an associated card.
146.	Units have a Location .
146.1.	A Unit's Location is the Base or Battlefield it currently occupies. <i>See rule 197. Locations for more information.</i>
147.	Gear
148.	Gear are:

148.1.	A Game Object
148.1.a.	While on the Board .
148.1.a.1.	Gear can only be played to a player's Base unless an effect specifies otherwise.
148.1.a.2.	Gear and their details are Public Information while on the Board .
148.1.a.3.	Gear can be chosen, affected, or manipulated by spells, effects, or game actions that specify Gear .
148.1.a.4.	Gear can be Killed . <i>See rule 428. Kill for more information.</i>
148.1.b.	While in the Trash
148.1.b.1.	Gear are treated as Cards before Game Objects , similar to the Hand .
148.1.b.2.	They retain the properties of being Gear , but are not on the Board and thus cannot take actions or be affected by spells, abilities, or game actions that affect Gear on the Board .
148.1.b.3.	Gear can be affected by spells and game effects that affect Gear in the Trash .
148.2.	A Card Type
148.2.a.	This is a unique identifier that some spells or abilities will use to restrict what they can choose or affect.
148.2.b.	The card type is relevant in all zones.
149.	Gear have several Intrinsic Properties unique to them.
149.1.	Gear enter play Ready .
149.2.	Gear can only be played to a player's Base unless an effect specifies otherwise.
149.3.	If an unattached non- Unit Gear is at a Battlefield for any reason during a cleanup, then it is recalled to its controller's Base as a corrective action. <i>See rule 454. Recalls for more information.</i> <i>See rule 318. Cleanups for more information.</i>
150.	Gear can have the Equipment tag.
150.1.	These Gear are referred to as Equipment .
150.2.	Equipment have effect text and a Might bonus. <i>See rule 136. Effect Text for more information on effect text.</i> <i>See rule 137. Might Bonus for more information on Might bonuses.</i>
150.3.	Equipment can have the Equip or Quick-Draw keywords. <i>See rule 818. Equip for more information on the Equip keyword.</i> <i>See rule 819. Quick-Draw for more information on the Quick-Draw keyword.</i>
150.4.	Equipment are still Gear and have the same intrinsic properties and rules that Gear do.
150.5.	Equipment and whether a Gear has the Equipment tag is a characteristic of the Gear may be checked or referenced by other Game Effects .
151.	Gear may have Activated Abilities .
151.1.	Activated Abilities are Game Effects that are written as Costs followed by a ":", and then succeeded

	by an effect. See rule 376. Activated Abilities for more information.
151.2.	The Activated Ability of Gear may be executed at any time during the controlling player's Main Phase during an Open State, and not during a Showdown.
151.2.a.	This follows the same process as playing a card. See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.
151.2.a.1.	This behaves, once activated, like a spell without an associated card.
152.	Gear have a Location.
152.1.	A Gear's Location is the Base or Battlefield it currently occupies. See rule 197. <i>Locations</i> for more information.
152.2.	Non-Unit Gear cannot normally become located at a Battlefield unless by some special means. <i>Example:</i> Gear are played to Base unless an effect specifies otherwise. A gear played from Facedown, which is specified to be played to the Battlefield it was played from, will enter at that Battlefield. Gear can also become located at a Battlefield if they are attached to a unit who becomes located at a Battlefield. A Gear that is a Unit can move to a Battlefield. See rule 811. Hidden for more information. See rule 716. Attachment for more information.
153.	Spells
154.	Spell is a card type.
155.	A spell can be played during an Open State outside of Showdowns on its controller's turn.
156.	A spell is controlled by the player who played it.
157.	A spell creates a game effect according to its instructions and is then placed in the Trash of the player who owns it.
158.	When a spell is successfully played, a player executes the rules text of the spell. This is called Resolving the spell.
158.1.	Spells have their rules text executed from top to bottom when they are Resolved.
158.2.	If a later part of a spell applies a Replacement Effect that alters earlier parts of the spell, apply those replacement effects as appropriate. <i>Example:</i> A spell says "Choose a unit. Kill it the next time it takes damage this turn." and "[Legion] — Kill it now instead. (<i>Get the effect if you've played another card this turn.</i>)" If the Legion condition is satisfied, the unit is killed immediately and the instruction to kill it the next time it takes damage is ignored, even if the unit remains on the board somehow. See rule 367. Replacement Effects for more information.
158.3.	While a spell or ability on the chain is Resolving, no other spells or abilities can be finalized on the chain or resolved, including triggered abilities or game effects that would occur as a result of the execution of the spell.
158.3.a.	Finish resolving <i>all effects</i> of a spell before addressing any chain items or Tasks the spell may have added or made outstanding through execution.
159.	Certain Keywords on spells are not executable rules text, but instead intrinsic properties of the spell.
159.1.	These determine inherent properties and behaviors of the spell before being played or while on the chain.
159.2.	These keywords are:
159.2.a.	Action

159.2.a.1.	This indicates that, in addition to being able to be played during an Open State , this spell may <i>also</i> be played during Open States during Showdowns . <i>See rule 806. Action for more information.</i>
159.2.b.	Reaction
159.2.b.1.	Grants all cases and rules of Action .
159.2.b.2.	In addition to all prior cases, may <i>also</i> be played during all forms of Closed State .
159.2.b.3.	This will result in this spell resolving before spells and abilities that are already on the chain. <i>See rule 813. Reaction for more information.</i>
160.	Runes
161.	Rune is a Card Type .
161.1.	A Rune is not a Main Deck card.
161.1.a.	This means, despite remaining on the Board until Recycled or otherwise removed from the board, it is <i>not</i> a Permanent .
161.2.	Runes are kept in the Rune Deck .
161.2.a.	Exactly 12 Rune cards chosen during Deck Construction. <i>See rule 103.3. Rune Deck for more information.</i>
161.2.b.	When a Rune is Recycled it is returned to the Rune Deck , not the Main Deck . <i>See rule 416. Recycle for more information.</i>
162.	Runes produce the resources needed to pay costs.
163.	Runes produce Energy and Power .
163.1.	Energy is used to pay numeric Energy costs .
163.1.a.	Energy has no Domain.
163.1.b.	Energy has no type.
163.2.	Power is used to pay Domain-associated Power Costs .
163.2.a.	Power has a Domain.
163.2.a.1.	Power 's Domain usually corresponds to the Domain of the Rune that produced it.
163.2.b.	Some Power is Universal and can be used to pay for costs of any Domain.
164.	Basic Runes
164.1.	There are six Basic Runes , each with a Domain corresponding to its name: Fury Rune Calm Rune Mind Rune Body Rune Chaos Rune Order Rune
164.2.	A Basic Rune always has the following two Abilities :
164.2.a.	[E]: [Reaction] — Add [1].

164.2.b.	Recycle this: [Reaction] — Add [C].
164.2.b.1.	The Power added this way corresponds to the Domain of the Rune that is being Recycled .
165.	Rune Pools
166.	The Rune Pool is a conceptual collection of a player's available Energy and Power available to pay Costs .
166.1.	When a card adds Energy or Power , it is added to the controlling player's Rune Pool .
166.2.	Players must add Energy and Power to their Rune Pool in order to be able to spend it to play cards or pay for Abilities with costs.
166.3.	Energy and Power do not have a physical marker or tracker, although players may wish to use a physical tracker if they are retaining unspent Energy and Power over the course of their turn.
167.	Every player's Rune Pool empties at the start of each player's Main Phase and the end of each player's turn.
167.1.	Any unspent Energy or Power are lost.
168.	All Abilities that include the action " Add " are abilities that are adding Energy or Power to the Rune Pool . <i>See rule 429. Add for more information.</i>
169.	Battlefields
170.	Battlefields are Game Objects .
170.1.	Battlefields are Owned by a player.
170.2.	Battlefields are not shuffled into Decks at the start of a game.
170.2.a.	Battlefields are not played during the course of regular play.
170.2.b.	Battlefields are established at the start of a game and remain in place for the duration of regular play.
170.3.	Battlefields cannot be Killed during the course of regular play.
170.4.	Battlefields cannot be Moved .
170.5.	Battlefields are Locations .
170.5.a.	Battlefields can be Origins of moves.
170.5.b.	Battlefields can be Destinations of moves.
170.6.	Any number of Units can be present at a Battlefield .
170.7.	Battlefields can be targeted by spells or game effects.
170.8.	Battlefields can have Passive Abilities . <i>See rule 363. Passive Abilities for more information.</i>
170.9.	Battlefields can have Triggered Abilities . <i>See rule 382. Triggered Abilities for more information.</i>
170.10.	Battlefields can have Activated Abilities . <i>See rule 376. Activated Abilities for more information.</i>
170.11.	Battlefields can be referenced in different states in card text:

170.11.a.	Battlefields can be “occupied.” This means they have a Unit present.
170.11.b.	Battlefields can be “uncontrolled.” This means no player controls them.
170.11.c.	Battlefields can be “open.” This means they are unoccupied and uncontrolled.
171.	Battlefields are not Permanents .
172.	The number of Battlefields on the Board is determined by the Mode of Play .
173.	Legends
174.	Legends are Game Objects .
174.1.	Legends are Owned by a player.
174.2.	Legends are not shuffled into Decks at the start of a game.
174.2.a.	Legends are not played during the course of regular play.
174.2.b.	Legends are established at the start of a game, and remain in place for the duration of regular play.
174.3.	Legends cannot be Killed during the course of regular play.
174.4.	Legends cannot be Moved .
174.5.	Legends can be targeted by spells or game effects.
174.6.	Legends can have Passive Abilities . <i>See rule 363. Passive Abilities for more information.</i>
174.7.	Legends can have Triggered Abilities . <i>See rule 382. Triggered Abilities for more information.</i>
174.8.	Legends can have Activated Abilities . <i>See rule 376. Activated Abilities for more information.</i>
175.	Legends are not Permanents .
176.	Legends may have one or more Domains .
176.1.	The Champion Legend determines the Domain Identity of cards its owner can include. <i>See rule 101. Deck Construction for more information.</i>
177.	Multiple Types
178.	Game Objects can have multiple types.
178.1.	A Game Object that is more than one type has the properties of all of their types, except where they are mutually exclusive.
178.1.a.	Regardless of a Game Objects' other types, there are some properties that are true of Game Objects of certain types. These properties take precedence when properties are mutually exclusive.
178.1.a.1.	If a Game Object is a Unit , regardless of its other types, it has Might , can have damage marked on it, enters exhausted, and can be played to any valid location.
178.1.a.1.a.	It will not be recalled to base in step 5 of a cleanup.

178.1.a.2.	If a Game Object is a Rune , regardless of its other types, it will be recycled to the Rune Deck .
178.2.	A Game Object that is more than one type maintains all of the permissions of all types.
178.2.a.	If a Game Object is a Unit , it has the standard move inherent ability.
178.2.a.1.	It can move and become located at a Battlefield.
178.3.	A Game Object that is more than one type can be affected by Game Effects that modify or interact with any of its types. <i>Example:</i> A unit that is also a gear can be affected by spells and abilities like the Ruination or Thermo Beam that say “Kill all units,” or “Kill all gear.” A unit that is also a gear can be targeted by spells and abilities like Vengeance or Rocket Barrage that say “Kill a unit,” or “Kill a gear.”
179.	Tokens
180.	Tokens are Game Objects created by spells and abilities during play.
181.	Tokens can be represented by anything. Printed tokens are included in Riftbound booster packs, but they are not required to play a token.
182.	A token's controller is the controller of the spell or ability that created it, unless the token's type innately determines control or that spell or ability specifies that a different player is the token's controller.
183.	A token's owner is the player who controlled the effect that created it.
184.	The effect that creates a token may specify the conditions or circumstances under which it enters the board. These stipulations may alter the usual steps for playing a card if the token is played.
184.1.	The effect may state that the token enters ready or exhausted, if that state is contrary to the default for the token's type.
184.2.	The effect may restrict the location to which the token may be played.
184.3.	The effect may grant temporary abilities or modifications to the token.
185.	Tokens are not cards.
185.1.	“Token” is an intrinsic category of Game Objects , in the same way “card” is.
185.1.a.	Token Game Objects cannot lose their token nature by any means.
185.1.b.	Card Game Objects cannot become tokens by any means.
185.2.	Tokens have some properties in common with cards.
185.2.a.	Tokens can be played by their owner if their card type is played, following all the applicable steps for playing a card plus any restrictions or modifications from the effect that created the token. <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.</i>
185.2.b.	Token units have a Might .
185.2.c.	Tokens may have one or more tags .
185.2.d.	Tokens have a type. They follow all rules for their type unless otherwise specified. <i>Example:</i> A token unit is a unit. It enters exhausted, can take the standard move action, deals damage equal to its Might in combat, is destroyed if it takes damage equal to or greater than its might, can be chosen or otherwise affected by spells or abilities that choose or affect units, etc.

185.2.e.	Tokens inherit the recycle destination of their type. <i>Example:</i> Token runes will be recycled to the Rune Deck. Token units, gear, and spells will be recycled to the Main Deck. Token battlefields and legends can't be recycled.
185.3.	Tokens differ from cards in some ways.
185.3.a.	Tokens do not have costs .
185.3.a.1.	Although tokens do not have costs, their cost is treated as being 0 for all purposes.
185.3.a.2.	Tokens can have costs appended to them via applied Layer effects. <i>Example:</i> Deceiver's conquer effect creates a 0 [M] Reflection unit token and applies a copy effect to that token. The copy effect will append all copyable traits, including the cost of the unit to be copied. This appends a cost to the Reflection token.
185.3.b.	Tokens do not have domains .
185.3.b.1.	Tokens can have domains appended to them via applied Layer effects. <i>Example:</i> A card reads in part "As you play this, pick a domain. All units and gear are that domain." If that card is in play, any unit and gear tokens will have the chosen domain appended to them.
186.	Tokens are Created on the board or the Chain and cannot exist elsewhere.
186.1.	If a token is put into any Non-Board Zone besides the chain, it ceases to exist immediately after moving to its new zone.
187.	The spell or ability that Creates a token specifies some of its characteristics. It may have other characteristics, as listed below.
187.1.	A 1 [M] Recruit token is a domainless unit token with 1 Might and the Recruit tag.
187.2.	A 3 [M] Sprite token with Temporary is a domainless unit token with 3 Might, the Fae tag, and the Temporary keyword. See rule 816. Temporary for more information.
187.3.	A 2 [M] Sand Soldier token is a domainless unit token with 2 Might and the Shurima tag.
187.4.	A 3 [M] Mech token is a domainless unit token with 3 Might and the Mech tag.
187.5.	A Gold gear token is a domainless gear token with "[Reaction][>] Kill this, [E]: [Add] [A]."
187.6.	A 0 [M] Reflection token is a domainless unit token with 0 Might.
187.7.	A 1 [M] Bird token is a domainless unit token with 1 Might, the Bird tag, and the Deflect keyword. See rule 809. Deflect for more information.
187.8.	A Brush battlefield token is a domainless battlefield token with "Bird, Cat, Dog, Poro, and Ivern units here have +1 [M]" and "When you score here, you may replace this with the battlefield it replaced."
187.9.	The Baron Pit battlefield token is a domainless battlefield token with "Units can move here from anywhere."
187.10.	A 1 [M] Tentacle token is a domainless unit token with 1 Might and the Bilgewater tag.
187.11.	A 0 [M] Shadow Clone token is a domainless unit token with 0 Might and "When I attack, you may banish a unit from your trash. If you do, give me [Assault 4] this turn." See rule 807. Assault for more information.
188.	Control

189.	Control is the concept of a player having influence of a Game Object and applies differently to different card types.
190.	Battlefields
190.1.	Control is established over Battlefields through the course of play.
190.2.	Control is a binary state for Battlefields and an Identifier for players.
190.2.a.	A Battlefield is Controlled or Uncontrolled .
190.2.b.	A Battlefield is Controlled by a specific player or Controlled by no one.
190.3.	Control can be Contested through the course of play.
190.3.a.	Contested is a temporary status applied to the battlefield when a Unit controlled by a Player who does not currently Control that Battlefield Moves or otherwise becomes present there.
190.3.a.1.	Units moving to or being played to a battlefield apply Contested status if that battlefield is not already Contested and that Unit's controller does not already control that battlefield.
190.3.b.	Once a Showdown or Combat begins at a Battlefield , it remains Contested until Control is established or re-established.
190.3.b.1.	If a player who applied Contested status to a Battlefield controls no Units there and there is no ongoing Showdown or Combat at that Battlefield , then Contested status is removed in the following Cleanup.
190.3.c.	The state of a Battlefield being Contested is used to determine when Combat should occur and when a Non-Combat Showdown should occur.
190.3.d.	At this time Game Effects cannot reference this status.
190.4.	Control is established by having Units at a Battlefield at the end of a Showdown or Combat after applying the contested status.
190.4.a.	If a player controls Units at a Battlefield , outside of Combat , they maintain Control of that Battlefield for as long as they have Units at that Battlefield .
190.4.b.	While a Combat or Showdown is ongoing at a Battlefield , Control of that Battlefield cannot change until instructed by steps of the Combat or Showdown .
190.4.c.	If a player has no Units at a Battlefield and the turn is in an Open state, they lose Control of that Battlefield in the following cleanup unless there is a Combat or Showdown ongoing there.
190.5.	Control is a constant state.
190.6.	Control of a Battlefield determines Control of its Abilities .
190.6.a.	While a Battlefield is Controlled , its Controller controls its Abilities unless that ability indicates another player does. The controlling player takes responsibility for adding them to the Chain if applicable, and makes all choices required by them unless otherwise specified.

190.6.b.	While a Battlefield is Uncontrolled, its Abilities are also Uncontrolled unless that ability indicates a player controls it. If there is no such indication, the Turn Player takes responsibility for adding them to the Chain if applicable, makes all choices required by them unless otherwise specified, and is treated as their Controller if any game rule or effect requires one. <i>Example:</i> The Arena's Greatest is a battlefield that reads "At the start of each player's first Beginning Phase, that player gains 1 point." This ability will usually trigger while the battlefield has no controller. If it does, the Turn Player goes through the steps of adding the ability to the chain and receives priority after doing so, exactly as if they controlled the ability.
190.6.c.	If an Ability of a Battlefield indicates that a specific player makes a choice, that player is the Ability's controller. They take responsibility for adding it to the chain if applicable and make all choices required by the ability. They and only they control the ability, regardless of who controls the Battlefield. <i>Example:</i> Abandoned Hall is a battlefield that reads "When a player plays a spell, they may give a unit they control here +1 might this turn." The ability indicates that the player who played the spell makes the choice, so that player takes responsibility for putting the ability on the chain and makes all choices. They control the triggered ability.
190.6.d.	"You" in a battlefield's abilities refers to the battlefield's Controller, as does the implied "you" in instructions that don't specify a player like "draw 1." If the battlefield has no Controller, "you" refers to no one, and all such instructions are ignored.
191.	Everything Else
191.1.	When a player Plays, Hides, or Creates a Card or other Game Object , they are established as that Game Object's Controller .
191.2.	For Spells , they are the Spell's Controller .
191.2.a.	That player chooses targets.
191.2.b.	That player chooses modes.
191.2.c.	That player pays costs.
191.3.	For Permanents and Runes , when they Enter the Board , that player is assigned as that Game Object's Controller .
191.3.a.	That player may make decisions about the Game Object's Inherent Abilities .
191.3.b.	That player may make decisions about the Game Object's Unique Abilities .
191.3.c.	That player may make decisions about any game effects or decisions necessary while the card is being played.
191.3.d.	That player may make decisions about any game effects created from "When you play me" effects of Permanents .
191.4.	For Abilities , they are the Ability's Controller .
191.4.a.	By default, the Controller of an Ability's Source is the Controller of that Ability .
191.4.a.1.	If an Ability's Source is located in a non-Board Zone , the Ability's Controller is the Owner of the Source .
191.4.b.	Changes to Control of an Ability's Source do not change Control of that Ability .
191.4.c.	That player chooses targets.

191.4.d.	That player chooses modes.
191.4.e.	That player pays costs.
192.	When a game effect or rules text refers to the Controller of a specific object, it can be referring to either context interchangeably.
192.1.	The method of assignment of control is different, but the status of Control is the same across all Game Objects .
193.	Winning
194.	Players win <i>Riftbound</i> games primarily through gaining points .
194.1.	Players can gain points a number of ways:
194.1.a.	Holding a Battlefield. <i>See rule 467. Scoring for more information.</i>
194.1.b.	Conquering a Battlefield. <i>See rule 467. Scoring for more information.</i>
194.1.c.	Spells, Triggered Abilities and Activated Abilities that instruct them to gain one or more points.
194.1.d.	When an opponent Burns Out and picks that player to gain 1 point. <i>See rule 431. Burn Out for more information.</i>
194.2.	A player wins the game if, in a cleanup, they have points greater than or equal to the Victory Score and more points than any other player. <i>See rule 318. Cleanups for more information.</i>
194.2.a.	If more than one player has points greater than or equal to the Victory Score , whichever player has more points wins.
194.2.b.	If those players have the same number of points, play continues until one player has more points in a cleanup.
194.3.	The Victory Score is 8 points by default.
194.3.a.	Some game modes or card effects may alter the Victory Score. <i>See rule 481. Modes of Play for more information.</i>
194.4.	Players cannot have less than 0 points.
194.4.a.	If a player would lose 1 or more points while they have 0 points, nothing occurs.
194.4.b.	Any effects that trigger on a player losing points do not trigger.
195.	A player also wins the game if an effect instructs them to do so, or if they are the only player remaining in the game.
195.1.	If an effect instructs a player to lose the game, that player is immediately removed from the game. <i>See rule 649. Conceding for more information about being removed from the game.</i>
196.	When a player wins the game, the game ends.
197.	Locations
198.	Locations are the Game Objects and Zones where permanents and runes may be located.
198.1.	Locations include the Battlefields and the Bases .

198.2.	A permanent's Location is a characteristic of that permanent that may be referenced by Game Effects .
199.	A Game Object that comprises a Location is also a Game Object at that location.
199.1.	A Battlefield is both a location and also a Game Object at that location.
200.	Locations can be Destinations and Origins for movement. <i>See rule 445. Movement for more information.</i>
201.	Costs
202.	Some Game Effects will instruct players to pay resources, spend counters or XP, or perform game actions as a Cost in order to perform a linked Effect .
203.	Costs must be paid in order to get their linked Effect .
203.1.	Paying a Cost requires a player to perform the appropriate game action: pay resources, spend counters or XP, kill units, etc.
203.2.	The Cost is still considered paid even if the associated game action is replaced.
203.3.	If the game action associated with a Cost is impossible for any reason such that a player cannot perform it, then they cannot pay the Cost and they will not execute the linked Effect .
204.	Costs paid in this way might be:
204.1.	Base Costs: These costs are the most fundamental costs that must be paid to finalize a spell or ability.
204.1.a.	On cards, the Base Cost is found in the upper left corner of the card.
204.1.b.	On activated abilities, the Base Cost is the resource or instruction written before the “.”.
204.2.	Additional Costs: These Costs are in addition to the base cost of the spell or ability and will include “as an additional cost.”
204.2.a.	Additional Costs must be paid to finalize the spell or ability, in addition to the base cost.
204.3.	Costs within Instructions: These Costs are part of the resolution of a spell or ability, and will take the form “[do X] to [do Y].”
204.3.a.	When Costs within Instructions appear as the first part of the effect in triggered abilities, the cost is taken to be the base cost of the triggered ability. It must be paid to finalize the triggered ability. <i>Example:</i> Overzealous Fan is a unit that reads “When I defend, you may kill me to move an attacking unit to its base.” In order to finalize the ability to the chain, its controller must kill Overzealous Fan.
204.3.b.	When Costs within Instructions appear in spells, activated abilities, or in later parts of triggered abilities, the cost must be paid to get the effect during resolution of the spell or ability. <i>Example:</i> Bullet Time is a spell that reads “Pay any amount of [A] to deal that much damage to all enemy units at a battlefield.” As the spell resolves, its controller pays any amount of [A] as a cost, and deals that much damage to all units at a battlefield as the effect. <i>Example:</i> Ancient Henge is a gear that reads “[Reaction][>] [E]: Pay any amount of Energy to Add that much [A].” As the ability resolves, its controller pays any amount of Energy as a cost, and Adds that much [A] as the effect. <i>Example:</i> Insightful Investigator is a unit that reads “When you play me, choose an opponent. They reveal their hand. You may pay 2 XP to choose a card from their

	hand. If you do, they discard that card and draw 1.” As the ability resolves, its controller may pay 2 XP as a cost, and chooses a card from that player’s hand as the effect.
204.4.	Applied Costs: These Costs are applied to one or more Game Actions, and typically take the form of a passive ability with a Cost within Instructions preceded by “must.” <i>Example:</i> Mageseeker Investigator reads in part “Opponents must pay [A] for each unit beyond the first to move multiple units to my battlefield at the same time.” This is an applied cost.
204.4.a.	The associated Game Action is the linked Effect for the Cost.
204.4.b.	Applied Costs are paid as the Game Action is performed. They do not use the chain and cannot be reacted to.
204.4.b.1.	Abilities that Add resources with the Reaction keyword can be activated at any time when costs need to be paid. <i>See rule 429. Add for more information.</i>
204.4.c.	If a player can’t pay or chooses not to pay the Applied Cost, they cannot perform the associated Game Action.
205.	An instruction that requires a player to pay resources or spend counters or XP that does not also have a linked Effect, is not a Cost. <i>Example:</i> A card effect reads, “When I attack, you may pay [4][C]. If you do, kill a unit here.” Paying [4][C] in this way is not a cost of the ability, base or otherwise, but a game action being performed by a player. The later instruction checks whether the game action was performed, not whether a cost was paid—if paying [4][C] was replaced for any reason, the later linked instruction will not execute.
206.	Effects that need to determine a card’s cost for any purpose always use its printed or copied cost, even if that cost is increased, decreased, or ignored as the card is played. <i>Example:</i> Sky Splitter is a spell that costs [8] and says in part “This spell’s Energy cost is reduced by the highest Might among units you control.” Lux, Illuminated is a unit that says “When you play a spell that costs 5 or more, give me +3 [M] this turn.” If a player who controls Lux plays Sky Splitter, Lux’s ability will trigger, regardless of how much was actually paid for Sky Splitter. <i>Example:</i> Defy is a spell which reads “Counter a spell that costs no more than [4] and no more than [A].” Rocket Barrage is a spell that costs [4][C] and has a Repeat cost of [4][C]. Rocket Barrage is a legal target for Defy even if Rocket Barrage’s Repeat cost is paid, because Defy only checks the printed or copied cost of its target. <i>Example:</i> Atakhan is a unit that reads in part “You may kill a friendly unit as an additional cost to play me. If you do, I cost [1] less for each Energy it costs and [Y] less for each Power it costs.” If a player plays Atakhan and chooses to kill a Reflection token that is currently a copy of Noxus Hopeful, Atakhan will cost [4] less.
206.1.	Effects that need to determine an ability’s cost for any purpose use its base cost, ignoring any alterations to that base cost unless otherwise specified. <i>Example:</i> A card reads “When you play an activated ability with Energy cost [7] or more, you may exhaust me to ready up to 2 runes.” A gear has an activated ability that reads “[12], Banish this: Choose an opponent. Banish all units they control. This ability costs [1] less for each point the chosen opponent has.” The ability of the first card will trigger when the activated ability is played, even if the chosen opponent has 6 or more points. <i>Example:</i> An equipment has an ability that reads “Equip [4][A]. This ability costs [1] less for each occupied enemy battlefield.” If its controller plays a unit with Weaponmaster, the Weaponmaster trigger will refer to the cost including the alterations. This is because Weaponmaster specifies that it includes modifications to the cost.

300.	Playing the Game
301.	The Turn
302.	Play continues cyclically until one player wins.
303.	The phases of a turn are rigid, but the actions taken during those steps can be done in any order, unless otherwise specified.
303.1.	Game Actions of any nature are performed one at a time and are executed completely.
303.2.	Game Actions cannot be performed simultaneously for any reason.
303.2.a.	If one or more game actions, game effects, or Triggered Abilities are activated simultaneously, then Turn Order is referenced to organize the sequence of actions, starting with the current Turn Player. <i>See rule 382. Triggered Abilities for more information.</i>
304.	The Turn Player is the player taking the current turn.
305.	When there are no items on the Chain and the Turn Player cannot or chooses not to perform any Discretionary Actions , the current phase or step of the turn ends and the next phase, step, or turn begins.
306.	The Turn Player changes when the current Turn Player reaches the End of all of the Phases of their Turn .
307.	States of the Turn
308.	At any given time, the turn is in either a Neutral State or a Showdown State .
308.1.	If a Showdown or Combat is in progress, the turn is in a Showdown State .
308.1.a.	Only cards and abilities with the Action or Reaction keywords can be played or activated in a Showdown State .
308.2.	If no Showdown or Combat is in progress, the turn is in a Neutral State .
309.	At any given time, the turn is in either an Open State or a Closed State .
309.1.	If a Chain exists, the turn is in a Closed State .
309.1.a.	Only cards and abilities with the Reaction keyword can be played or activated in a Closed State .
309.2.	If no Chain exists, the turn is in an Open State .
310.	These descriptions can be combined, such that the turn is always in one of these four states:
310.1.	Neutral Open: There is no Showdown or Combat in progress and no Chain exists.
310.1.a.	By default, cards can be played and abilities activated only when a player has priority on their turn in a Neutral Open state.
310.2.	Neutral Closed: There is no Showdown or Combat in progress and a Chain exists.
310.3.	Showdown Open: A Showdown or Combat is in progress and no Chain exists.
310.4.	Showdown Closed: A Showdown or Combat is in progress and a Chain exists.
311.	Priority and Focus

312.	At any given time, up to one player has Priority .
312.1.	Priority is the singular exclusive right to take Discretionary Actions . See rule 410.1. Discretionary Actions for more information.
312.1.a.	The player with Priority can take appropriately timed Discretionary Actions .
312.1.b.	If no player has Priority , no player can take Discretionary Actions .
312.1.b.1.	Players can always take and make choices for Limited Actions when instructed, regardless of Priority .
312.2.	A player receives Priority at the following times:
312.2.a.	When the turn is in a Neutral Open State during their Main Phase .
312.2.b.	When the turn is in a Showdown State and they gain Focus .
312.2.c.	When the turn is in a Closed State , all pending chain items finish being finalized, and they control the next item on the Chain .
312.2.d.	When the turn is in a Closed State , they are the next Player in Turn Order , and the player with Priority passes.
312.3.	When a player is granted Priority , it is either created if no player has it or taken from the player with Priority .
313.	At any given time, up to one player has Focus .
313.1.	Focus is the permission to take appropriately timed Discretionary Actions when the turn is in a Showdown Open State . See rule 307. States of the Turn for more information.
313.1.a.	The player with Focus must obey any additional restrictions on which Discretionary Actions may be performed. <i>Example:</i> A player with Focus may not play spells or activate abilities that don't have the Action or Reaction keywords.
313.2.	A player who gains Focus also gains Priority .
313.3.	A player who passes Priority retains Focus .
313.4.	A player may not make discretionary actions with Focus unless they also possess Priority .
313.5.	If the turn is in a Neutral State , no player has Focus .
314.	Phases of the Turn
315.	Start of Turn
315.1.	<i>Awaken Phase</i>
315.1.a.	The following Task becomes Outstanding :
315.1.b.	1. The Turn Player readies all Game Objects they control that are able to be readied. See rule 415. Ready for more information.
315.2.	<i>Beginning Phase</i>
315.2.a.	Beginning Step
315.2.a.1.	At the start of Beginning Phase game effects take place.

315.2.b.	Scoring Step
315.2.b.1.	The following Task becomes Outstanding :
315.2.b.2.	1. The Turn Player Holds all Battlefields they Control . <i>See rule 467. Scoring for more information.</i>
315.2.b.3.	<i>Reminder: In Modes of Play with Teams, Battlefields controlled by a Teammate of the Turn Player during this step are disqualified from being scored this turn by the Turn Player.</i>
315.3.	Channel Phase
315.3.a.	The following Task becomes Outstanding :
315.3.b.	1. The Turn Player channels 2 runes from their Rune Deck . <i>See rule 430. Channel for more information.</i>
315.3.b.1.	If there are fewer than 2 runes in the Rune Deck , they channel as many as possible.
315.4.	Draw Phase
315.4.a.	The following Task becomes Outstanding :
315.4.b.	1. The Turn Player draws 1.
315.4.b.1.	If there are no cards remaining in their Main Deck to draw, the Turn Player has been Burned Out . <i>See rule 431. Burn Out for more information.</i>
315.4.b.2.	After completing the Burn Out the Turn Player still Draws 1 .
316.	Main Phase
316.1.	When all steps of the Start of Turn have been completed, the Main Phase begins.
316.2.	The following Tasks become Outstanding in the specified order:
316.3.	1. Each player's Rune Pool empties. Any unspent Energy and Power are lost. <i>See rule 165. Rune Pools for more information.</i>
316.4.	2. At the start of Main Phase game effects take place.
316.5.	The Main Phase has no defined structure.
316.5.a.	A player may take any number of Discretionary Actions they are able to perform during this phase. <i>See rule 410.1. Discretionary Actions for more information.</i>
316.5.b.	This is denoted as a Neutral Open State , and only the Turn Player has the ability to play spells or activate abilities. <i>See rule 307. States of the Turn for more information.</i>
316.5.b.1.	In Modes of Play with teammates, the Turn Player's teammates may play spells and activate abilities, including ones without Action or Reaction . They can only do so when the Turn Player invites them to do so with their own Priority .
316.6.	As a result of a player taking Discretionary Actions , one or more structured phases may occur.
316.7.	Combat

316.7.a.	A Combat occurs as a result of Units controlled by opposing players being present at the same Battlefield .
316.7.b.	This could be the result of a Standard Move Intrinsic Ability, a Spell , or other Game Effect .
316.7.c.	The source effect does not change the structure or flow of Combat once initiated.
316.7.d.	A Combat can only occur between two players. <i>See rule 459. Combat for more information.</i>
316.7.e.	Play proceeds following the steps of combat. <i>See rule 463. The Steps of Combat for more information.</i>
316.7.f.	Combat will also include a Showdown .
316.8.	Showdowns
316.8.a.	A Showdown occurs when a Combat occurs.
316.8.a.1.	Showdowns that occur as a result of Combat are a Sub-Phase of Combat .
316.8.b.	A Showdown is marked as Staged at a Battlefield in the cleanup after the Contested status is applied to that Battlefield .
316.8.b.1.	Showdowns that occur as a result of a player moving to an empty Battlefield are a stand-alone Phase and do not create a Combat .
316.8.b.1.a.	These Showdowns are called Non-Combat Showdowns . During the proceedings of a Non-Combat Showdown , units controlled by a different player may become present at the Battlefield where the Showdown is ongoing. This will cause the Showdown to become a Combat Showdown in the following cleanup.
316.8.c.	A Showdown is a structured Window of Opportunity where Players may play cards and activate abilities with Action or Reaction . <i>See rule 341. Showdowns for more information.</i>
316.9.	When a player has no more Discretionary Actions they wish to execute, they must indicate they are ending their turn.
316.9.a.	This ends the Main Phase .
316.9.b.	Play proceeds to the Ending Phase .
317.	Ending Phase
317.1.	Ending Step
317.1.a.	At the end of the turn Game Effects take place.
317.1.b.	Specific game effects and abilities will reference this timing and phase as necessary.
317.2.	Expiration Step
317.2.a.	Invoke an Ending Special Cleanup . <i>See rule 318. Cleanups for more information.</i>
317.2.b.	Insert “3c. Heal all Units .”
317.2.c.	Insert “3d. All ‘this turn’ effects expire simultaneously.”
317.2.d.	Insert “3e. Each player’s Rune Pool empties. Any unspent Energy and Power are lost.”

317.2.e.	The following Task becomes Outstanding :
317.2.f.	1. If any items underwent the FEPR process, return to the start of the Expiration Step
317.3.	The next player with their Turn queued becomes the Turn Player .
318.	Cleanups
319.	A Cleanup will be made an Outstanding Task at the following times:
319.1.	After the game transitions to or from an Open or Closed state
319.2.	After the game transitions between Phases , unless specified otherwise
319.3.	After a Pending Item is added to the Chain
319.4.	After a Pending Item becomes a Finalized Item on the Chain
319.5.	After a Chain Item is removed from the Chain for any reason
319.6.	After any number of Game Objects enter or leave the Board
319.7.	After the status of any number of Game Objects changes for any reason
319.8.	After a Move is completed
320.	While a Cleanup is occurring, Chain Items cannot be Finalized or Resolved .
320.1.	New Pending Items can be added, but Finalized Items cannot be executed and Priority and Focus are not passed or awarded.
321.	Similarly, while Chain Items are Resolving , a Cleanup cannot occur.
321.1.	If an event occurs during the Resolution of a Chain Item that qualifies for a Cleanup , that Cleanup will be made an Outstanding Task .
322.	If an event occurs during a Cleanup that qualifies for a Cleanup , another Cleanup will occur immediately after the first completes, repeating until a Cleanup occurs with no new change in the game's state.
322.1.	These new Cleanups are themselves Outstanding Tasks .
323.	When a Cleanup occurs, the following Tasks become Outstanding in the order described:
323.1.	1. If a player has points greater than or equal to the Victory Score , and more points than any opponent, that player wins.
323.2.	2. Assign or Remove the Attacker or Defender designation from Units as needed if there is a Combat in progress
323.2.a.	If there are Units present at the Battlefield the Combat is taking place at, but do not have a designation, they gain the same designation as their Controller now
323.2.b.	If there are Units present at the Battlefield the Combat is taking place at, but have the opposite designation of their controller, they lose that designation, and gain the same designation as their controller now
323.2.c.	If there are Units at locations other than the Battlefield that the Combat is taking place at, but have either Attacker or Defender designations, they lose those designations now
323.3.	3. Handle outstanding board state
323.4.	3a. All Units that have Lethal Damage marked on them and that have Deathknell or other abilities

	that trigger on their own death will trigger such abilities now, making note of their current location, attributes, and other information relevant to add the trigger as a Pending Item <i>See rule 808 Deathknell for more information.</i>
323.5.	3b. All Units that have LethalDamage marked on them are killed and placed in their owners' Trash. <i>See rule 142.4. For more information on lethal damage.</i>
323.6.	4. Players lose control of any controlled Battlefields without their Units occupying them if the turn is in an Open State and there is no Showdown or Combat ongoing there.
323.7.	5. Recall all Unattached non-Unit Gear and non-Unit Runes at Battlefields, and all Permanents and Runes in Bases other than their controller's. Remove all Hidden cards from all Battlefields that are not controlled by the same player and place them in their owner's Trash.
323.8.	6. Mark a Showdown as Staged at each Battlefield that Contested was applied to.
323.8.a.	The Showdown remains Staged at that Battlefield as long as it is Contested and has units present controlled by the player that applied Contested.
323.9.	7. Mark a Combat as Staged at each Battlefield that Contested was applied to that have Units present controlled by opposing players.
323.9.a.	The Combat remains Staged at that Battlefield as long as there are Units present from two opposing players there.
323.10.	7a. If Units of two opposing players are no longer present at a Battlefield that has a Combat Staged before it has opened, the Combat will cease being Staged
323.11.	8. Remove Contested status from each Battlefield without Units controlled by the player who applied Contested to that Battlefield and without a Showdown or Combat ongoing there.
323.11.a.	If as a result of the removal of Contested status there are Units located at an uncontested Battlefield that their controller does not control, their controller applies Contested status to that Battlefield.
323.12.	9. If the current state is a Neutral Open State and one or more Showdowns are Staged at Battlefields without a Combat staged, the Turn Player chooses one of those Battlefields. A Showdown begins there.
323.13.	10. If the current state is a Neutral Open State and one or more Combats are Staged at Battlefields, the Turn Player chooses one of those Battlefields. Combat begins there.
323.14.	10a. If the current state is Showdown Open State and Combat is Staged at a Battlefield where there is a Non-Combat Showdown ongoing, that Showdown becomes a Combat Showdown.
324.	Special Cleanups are Cleanup steps invoked at specific times that have additional steps not present in a normal Cleanup.
324.1.	When a Special Cleanup is invoked, the unique steps added will be inserted and defined by the sub-section that invokes it. <i>Example: When a Combat Cleanup is invoked, the Combat section defines what steps are added to the Cleanup.</i> <i>See rule 466. The Resolution Step for more information.</i> <i>Example: When an End of Turn Cleanup is invoked, the End of Turn Phase subsection defines what steps are added to the Cleanup.</i> <i>See rule 317. The Ending Phase for more information.</i>
324.2.	If events during a Special Cleanup require another Cleanup, a normal Cleanup is invoked, not another iteration of the Special Cleanup.

325.	Chains and Showdowns
326.	Players can act during the following Windows of Opportunity that occur during the course of regular play:
326.1.	During a Chain
326.2.	During a Showdown
327.	Chains
328.	The Chain is a Non-Board Zone that temporarily exists whenever a card is played or an ability is activated.
328.1.	Cards, abilities, and tokens are placed here as part of the process of being played. <i>See rule 349. The Process of Play for more information.</i> <i>See rule 360. Abilities for more information on Abilities.</i>
329.	Cards, tokens, and abilities added to the chain are added as Pending Chain Items that become Finalized Chain Items .
329.1.	Pending Items are on the Chain.
329.2.	Chain Items are Pending until the “Check Legality” step of playing a card. <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.</i>
329.3.	When a Pending Chain Item is no longer Pending it is finalized and becomes a Finalized Chain Item .
330.	The Chain exists as long as a Chain Item is on it.
330.1.	Only one Chain can exist at a time.
330.2.	If a card or token would begin to be played while a Chain already exists, it is placed on the existing Chain .
331.	The State of the Turn is partially determined by whether or not the Chain currently exists.
331.1.	The turn is said to be in a Closed State if a Chain exists.
331.1.a.	Cards of all Categories, by default, cannot be played during a Closed State .
331.1.b.	Card abilities, by default, cannot be played during a Closed State .
331.2.	The turn is said to be in an Open State if <i>no Chain</i> exists.
332.	Handling Tasks and Resolving Chain Items
333.	A Task is one or more steps or processes that one or more Players <i>must</i> perform before continuing with any other actions.
333.1.	Tasks include, but are not limited to: Cleanups , the actions performed during the Start of Turn Process , throughout Combat in its various steps, and the actions performed during the End of Turn Process . <i>See rule 318. Cleanups for more information on Cleanups</i> <i>See rule 315. Start of Turn for more information on the Start of Turn process</i> <i>See rule 459. Combat for more information on the steps of Combat</i> <i>See rule 317. Ending Phase for more information.</i>
334.	Whenever a Player takes one or more actions that incur Tasks they should refer to the process of HOT FEPR: Handle Outstanding Tasks ; then Finalize , Execute , Pass , Resolve .
334.1.	In the course of Handling Outstanding Tasks, Chain Items may be added to the Chain . They will remain there until the Tasks are complete.

334.2.	When all Outstanding Tasks are completed, all pending Chain Items will subsequently be processed by the FEPR process.
334.2.a.	During the FEPR process, new Tasks may be incurred. Complete the current step of the process and then pause and complete the necessary Tasks before continuing.
335.	If there are no Outstanding Tasks , no pending Chain Items , no ongoing Showdown or Combat , and it is the Main Phase , the Turn Player receives priority. If there are no Outstanding Tasks , no pending Chain Items , no ongoing Showdown , and it is any other phase of the turn, proceed to the next substep, step, phase, or turn.
335.1.	If there are no Outstanding Tasks , no pending Chain Items , and there is an ongoing Showdown , the player with Focus receives priority.
336.	When there are no outstanding Tasks and there are pending Chain Items on the Chain , players should refer to the FEPR process to proceed.
336.1.	In the sequence of resolving FEPR more Chain Items may become Pending Chain Items . These will be processed by the same FEPR process that produced them.
337.	Step 1: Finalize
337.1.	If there is at least one Chain Item Pending , the controller of the oldest Pending Chain Item must complete the steps of Playing that Pending Item until it is a Finalized Item or leaves the Chain . <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information on finalizing chain items.</i>
337.1.a.	Finalizing an item to the chain does not pass Priority .
337.1.b.	Chain Items are Finalized in the order they were appended to the Chain .
337.2.	If, after finalizing the Chain Item, that item is a Unit , Gear , or an ability that Adds resources, it resolves immediately—Move to Step 4: Resolve. <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.</i>
337.3.	If, after finalizing the Chain Item, there are still Pending Chain Items , return to step 1. Finalize.
337.4.	If, after finalizing the Chain Item, there are no more items on the chain to be Finalized , the controller of the next item on the chain gains Priority . Move to step 2: Execute.
338.	Step 2: Execute
338.1.	The player with Priority may do any the following:
338.1.a.	Play a Card or Activated Ability that is legally timed .
338.1.a.1.	Cards and Activated Abilities , by default, cannot be played during a Closed State .
338.1.a.2.	A Legally Timed Card or Activated Ability would be one with Reaction or one that will have Reaction when played under appropriate circumstances.
338.1.a.3.	Other exceptions may be created during regular play.
338.1.a.4.	The Card or Activated Ability will be added to the chain as a Pending Item , following the steps of playing a card.
338.1.a.5.	This can be an additional item to the item that Started the Chain in the case of the first player with Priority after creating the Chain .
338.1.a.6.	Whether a Card or Activated Ability is legally timed is evaluated during the “Check Legality” step of Playing a Card . <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.</i> <i>See rule 398. Playing or Activating Abilities for more information.</i>

338.1.a.7.	Playing a Card or Activated Ability will create one or more Pending Items . Return to Step 1: Finalize.
338.1.b.	Pass Priority
338.1.b.1.	The player with Priority passes Priority to the next Player in Turn Order . Proceed to Step 3: Pass.
339.	Step 3: Pass
339.1.	If all players have passed Priority in sequence without adding any items to the Chain , proceed to Step 4: Resolve.
339.2.	Otherwise, the player with Priority passes Priority to the next Player in Turn Order . Return to Step 2: Execute.
340.	Step 4: Resolve
340.1.	The newest Finalized Chain Item resolves. Execute its game effects in their entirety. <i>See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information on resolving spells.</i> <i>See rule 398. Playing or Activating Abilities for more information on resolving abilities.</i>
340.2.	If the Chain is empty, play proceeds in an Open State .
340.2.a.	If this occurs during a Showdown and the chain wasn't initiated by a triggered ability or an ability that Adds resources, focus passes to the next player in turn order.
340.3.	If the Chain is not empty and there are one or more Pending Items , return to Step 1: Finalize.
340.4.	If the Chain is not empty and there are no Pending Items , the controller of the newest item on the chain gains Priority . Return to Step 2: Execute.
341.	Showdowns
342.	A Showdown is a Window of Opportunity in which Players have an Open State in which they may play Spells in an alternating fashion.
342.1.	Each spell played this way creates a Chain as normal.
343.	The State of the turn is partially determined by whether or not a Showdown or Combat is in progress.
343.1.	The turn is said to be in a Showdown State if a Showdown or Combat is in progress.
343.1.a.	Cards of all Categories, by default, cannot be played during a Showdown State .
343.1.b.	Card abilities, by default, cannot be played during a Showdown State .
343.2.	The turn is said to be in a Neutral State if no Showdown or Combat is in progress.
344.	A Showdown begins when Control of a Battlefield is Contested during a Cleanup and the turn is in a Neutral Open State .
344.1.	If Control of a Battlefield is Contested between two players, then a Showdown will be opened as the first step of Combat . If a Showdown is already ongoing at that Battlefield , it will become a Combat Showdown and a Combat will initiate there. <i>See rule 459. Combat for more information.</i>
344.2.	If Control of a Battlefield is Contested , there aren't units controlled by different players there, and the turn is in a Neutral Open State , a Showdown is opened during the next Cleanup . <i>See rule 318. Cleanups for more information.</i>
345.	As a Showdown begins, the player who applied Contested status to the Battlefield gains Focus .

346.	When the last item on the chain resolves and the turn returns to an Open State during a Showdown , Focus passes, and the next Player gains both Focus and Priority .
346.1.	Focus will not pass in this way if the chain opened as a result of a triggered ability being added to the chain, nor if it opened as a result of an Add ability being added to the chain. <i>Example:</i> the Combat Chain opens as a result of triggered abilities being added to the chain, so when the last item on the Combat Chain resolves and the turn returns to an Open State, Focus will not pass.
347.	During a Showdown , the player with Focus may do one of the following:
347.1.	Play a Card or Activated Ability that is legally timed .
347.1.a.	The card or activated ability will start a Chain as normal.
347.1.b.	When that Chain closes, Focus passes to the next Player in Turn Order .
347.2.	Pass.
347.2.a.	If all Players have passed once in sequence, the Showdown ends.
347.2.b.	Otherwise, Focus passes to the next Player in Turn Order .
348.	If all players pass Focus without playing a spell or activating an ability, then the Showdown Closes.
348.1.	If it is a Combat Showdown , proceed with the remaining steps of Combat to resolve the phase. <i>See rule 463. The Steps of Combat for more information.</i>
348.2.	If it is a Non-Combat Showdown , do the following:
348.2.a.	If only one player's Units remain at the Battlefield , and if that player does not already Control the Battlefield , that player establishes Control over the Battlefield . <i>See rule 188. Control for more information on Control.</i> <i>See rule 469.1. for more information on Conquering.</i>
348.2.a.1.	This results in a Conquer if that player has not yet scored that Battlefield this turn.
349.	Playing Cards
350.	Playing a card is the act of a player utilizing their cards.
350.1.	A card is Played when it has finished this process in its entirety.
350.2.	Tokens are not cards, but can still be Played . <i>See rule 179. Tokens for more information.</i>
351.	Cards have different behaviors when played.
351.1.	Permanents become Game Objects when Played .
351.2.	Spells create game effects that are executed, then the card is placed in the trash when Played .
352.	Cards have different states during the process of being played.
352.1.	When initially being played cards are Pending , as Pending Chain Items .
352.2.	Near the end of the process cards will cease being Pending and become Finalized Chain Items .
353.	The Process of Play
354.	1. Move the card from its current zone to the Chain .
354.1.	This Closes the State .

	See rule 307. States of the Turn for more information.
354.2.	This item becomes Pending , awaiting the finalization process (steps 2 - 5)
354.3.	If another Card Effect or ability is currently resolving, continue resolving it before proceeding with any further steps of this process.
354.4.	If there are Tasks outstanding or currently being handled, finish those Tasks before continuing this process. See rule 332. for more information on Tasks.
355.	2. Make relevant choices.
355.1.	If the card has an effect that specifies a choice "As I am played," those choices are made now.
355.1.a.	This includes the choice of whether or not to pay an Optional Additional Cost .
355.2.	For Units , choose a valid Location where that Unit will enter upon being Played .
355.2.a.	By default, Valid locations include the controller's Base or a Battlefield the controller controls.
355.2.b.	Some Game Effects may grant players permission to play Units to locations that are not normally Valid . Such locations become Valid for the purposes of Playing the Unit .
355.3.	For Spells and Abilities with a bulleted list of modes to choose from, make the appropriate choices now.
355.4.	For Spells and Abilities that Move one or more Units , choose a valid Location as the Move Destination for each Move that will be performed.
355.4.a.	A valid Location for a Move Effect is one other than the Units' current Location where they are allowed to be present.
355.5.	If a card requires you to specifically choose one or more Game Objects , that choice is made now.
355.5.a.	This does not include cards that <i>affect</i> one or more Game Objects based on criteria. <i>Example:</i> "Stun a unit at a battlefield" is a Choice . <i>Example:</i> "Kill all gear" is <i>not</i> a Choice .
355.5.b.	This does not include making choices for Triggered Abilities of permanents, or Delayed or Reflexive Triggers generated by the item being finalized, even if those abilities trigger when the chain item is played. <i>Example:</i> A unit with a triggered ability that says "When I'm played, kill a unit" does not require you to choose a target as it's played. The target will be chosen when the ability triggers. <i>Example:</i> Targon's Peak reads "When you conquer here, ready up to 2 runes at the end of this turn." Readyng up to 2 runes at the end of the turn is the effect of a delayed trigger; any choices involved are not made when finalizing the conquer effect but when finalizing the resulting delayed trigger at the end of the turn. See rule 382. Triggered Abilities for more information.
355.6.	Targeting
355.7.	When a card Chooses one or more specific Game Objects to affect, it is Targeted unless indicated otherwise by the rules in this section.
355.8.	In order to put a spell or ability on the chain, valid choices must be made for all targets.

355.9.	A target is a valid choice if it meets all of the following requirements:
355.9.a.	It is a permanent or rune on the board, a spell or ability on the chain, a player or zone, or specified explicitly or implicitly as being in some other zone. <i>e.g., “Kill a unit” targets a unit on the board.</i> <i>e.g., “Recycle a unit from your trash” targets a unit card in your trash.</i>
355.9.a.1.	“Unit,” “gear,” and “rune” refer to objects on the Board unless specified otherwise.
355.9.a.2.	“Spell” and “ability” refer to objects on the Chain unless specified otherwise.
355.9.a.3.	“Facedown card” refers to a card in a Facedown Zone unless specified otherwise.
355.9.a.4.	“Legend” refers to a legend in the Legend Zone.
355.9.a.5.	“Chosen Champion” and “unit in the Champion Zone” refer to a unit in the Champion Zone unless specified otherwise.
355.9.b.	It meets all targeting restrictions. <i>e.g., A unit is a valid target for a spell that refers to a “unit at a battlefield,” “enemy unit,” “unit you control,” or “unit with Might 4 or greater” only if it meets the appropriate criteria.</i> <i>e.g. A unit that reads “I can’t be chosen by enemy spells or abilities.” is not a valid target for any enemy spell or ability, even if it meets other targeting restrictions.</i>
355.9.c.	It is not the spell or ability itself. <i>e.g., A spell that says “Counter a spell” cannot target itself.</i> <i>e.g., An ability of a permanent can target that permanent, because abilities and their sources are separate objects.</i>
355.10.	A game object, player, or zone mentioned in the text of a spell, activated ability, or triggered ability is a target UNLESS any of the following are true:
355.10.a.	It is in a zone whose information status is not Public. <i>e.g., “Ready a legend” targets a legend, because the Legend Zone is Public.</i> <i>e.g., “Return a unit from your trash to your hand” targets a unit card in your trash, because your trash is Public.</i> <i>e.g., “You may play a unit from your hand, ignoring its costs” does not target a unit card in your hand, because your hand is not a public zone.</i>
355.10.a.1.	Public zones are Battlefield Zones, Bases, Trashes, Legend Zones, Champion Zones, and Facedown Zones.
355.10.b.	It is included only as part of a targeting restriction for another choice or only as a restriction or permission for a game action. <i>e.g., “Kill a unit at a battlefield” targets a unit, but not a battlefield, because the units are targets and “at a battlefield” is a restriction.</i> <i>e.g., “Kill all units at a battlefield” targets a battlefield, but not any units.</i> <i>e.g., “Play a unit from your hand to a battlefield” doesn’t target a battlefield.</i>
355.10.c.	It is included only as part of a cost, trigger condition, or replacement effect. <i>e.g., “As an additional cost to play me, kill a friendly unit” doesn’t target anything.</i> <i>e.g., “When a friendly unit dies, kill a gear” targets a gear, but not a friendly unit.</i> <i>e.g., “When you play me, the next time a friendly unit would die this turn, return it to your hand instead” doesn’t target anything. The replacement effect applies when any friendly unit dies.</i> <i>e.g., “Choose a friendly unit. The next time it would die this turn, return it to your hand instead” targets a friendly unit, because “choose a friendly unit” is not part of the replacement effect.</i>

355.10.c.1.	This includes costs within instructions, identified by phrases like “[do X] to [do Y].” The cost within that instruction is “[do X].” <i>e.g., “When I hold, you may kill another friendly unit here to draw 1” does not target anything.</i> <i>e.g., “When you play me, you may spend a buff to move a friendly unit” targets the friendly unit, but not the buff.</i>
355.10.d.	It is programmatically selected based on its characteristics rather than chosen by the spell or ability's controller. <i>e.g., “Kill all units at a battlefield” targets a battlefield, but does not target any units.</i> <i>e.g., “Kill all units at battlefields” doesn’t target anything.</i> <i>e.g., “Kill a unit. Its controller draws 2” targets the unit, but not its controller.</i> <i>e.g., “Ready your legend” doesn’t target anything, because you can only have one legend.</i> <i>e.g., “Ready a friendly legend” targets a legend, because in a 2v2 game there are two friendly legends.</i> <i>e.g., “Recycle all cards in your trash” doesn’t target anything, because it affects all cards and you only have one trash.</i>
355.10.d.1.	This exception applies solely to objects for which no choice is ever possible.
355.10.d.2.	This exception does not apply to objects that are the only valid choice at the moment a spell or ability is placed on the chain, but which would require a choice under other circumstances. <i>e.g., “Kill a unit at a battlefield” always targets a unit, even if that unit is the only unit currently at a battlefield.</i>
355.10.e.	It is part of a set of objects chosen in whole or in part by other players. <i>e.g., “Each player kills a unit they control” does not target. Each player, including the one who played the spell, chooses a unit to kill as the spell or ability resolves.</i>
355.10.f.	It is identified in an instruction that a player “must” complete. <i>e.g., “You must recycle one of your runes” doesn’t target anything. You choose from among your runes as the spell or ability resolves.</i> <i>e.g., “Recycle a rune you control” targets a rune. You choose a rune you control as you put the spell or ability on the chain.</i>
355.11.	Some cards identify a group of Targets with Targeting Requirements that must be met by the group as a whole.
355.11.a.	As they’re finalized on the chain, such cards can choose any group of valid targets that collectively fulfill the targeting restriction.
355.11.b.	If the group of targets no longer collectively fulfill the targeting restriction as the spell or ability resolves, that spell or ability's controller can choose a subset of the original targets that fulfills the targeting requirement for the spell or ability to affect. <i>Example:</i> A player plays Fox-Fire, a spell that says in part “Kill any number of units at a battlefield with total Might 4 or less.” That player chooses four 1 [M] Recruit tokens at a single battlefield. As a Reaction, another player gives two of those Recruits +1 [M], so the Recruits’ Might are 1, 1, 2, and 2. Then Fox-Fire resolves. The Recruits no longer have total Might 4 or less, so Fox-Fire’s controller must choose a legal subset of the original targets to affect. They could choose to kill the two 2 [M] Recruits, or the two 1 [M] Recruits plus one 2 [M] Recruit. The units they choose are Fox-Fire’s remaining legal targets. They can’t choose to affect units at the same battlefield that weren’t initially chosen as targets. They can, however, choose to affect units that were initially chosen as targets that left the chosen battlefield before Fox-Fire resolved as long as those units are all located at the same battlefield.

355.12.	If a spell specifies that a player <i>may</i> perform a Game Action on some number of Game Objects , then all choices are considered targeted and chosen independently of the decision to perform the Game Action .
355.13.	If a card specifies that a player chooses “any number” or “up to” some number of Game Objects to be affected, they may choose any number of available targets, including zero. If they choose zero, the spell or ability can be played without any targets.
355.14.	Splitting
355.14.a.	If a card specifies that an amount of damage may be <i>split</i> among some number of Units , then each Unit chosen is Targeted .
355.14.b.	The Targets are chosen when the spell or ability is finalized on the chain.
355.14.c.	A number of Targets can only be chosen up to, and not exceeding, the initial amount of damage available when the spell is played. <i>Example:</i> A player playing a spell that instructs them to "Split 5 damage" may only choose up to 5 units, but may choose fewer.
355.14.d.	Each Target is valid, and contributes to Targeting Effects individually.
355.14.e.	The choice of how much damage is divided across the split is not decided until the resolution of the spell or ability.
355.14.f.	Each Target must receive a valid amount of damage.
355.14.g.	Valid damage is a positive integer amount, greater than or equal to 1 damage. <i>See rule 417. Deal for more information.</i>
355.14.h.	If, at resolution of the spell or effect, there are more Targets than available damage to divide, then the player who controls the effect dealing damage determines which Targets cease being Targets .
355.14.h.1.	That player cannot choose to have fewer Targets than they have damage to split when choosing which Targets cease being Targets . <i>Example:</i> A player plays Alpha Strike, which reads in part “Choose a friendly unit. It deals damage equal to its Might split among enemy units at battlefields.” They target their 5 [M] unit and five 1 [M] enemy Recruits at battlefields. In reaction, their opponent plays Feral Strength targeting one of their recruits, and Frigid Touch targeting the 5 [M] unit. When Alpha Strike resolves, they have 3 damage to split, and must choose which targets cease being targets. They can’t choose for 4 of the units to cease being targets so that they can deal 3 to the 3 [M] recruit. They can only choose at most 2 of the targets to cease being targets.
355.14.i.	Any costs that were paid, or effects that were triggered as a result of those Game Objects being chosen as Targets remain in effect, paid, or otherwise triggered.
355.15.	These choices cannot be changed after this step unless instructed to by a spell or ability. <i>See rule 750. Making New Choices for more information.</i>
355.16.	A player may not make choices during this step that will deterministically result in illegal choices or actions later in this process unless they have no choice. <i>Example:</i> A player plays a card which reads “As an additional cost to play this, kill the unit you control with the most Might. Give a friendly unit +[M] equal to the killed unit’s Might this turn. Predict 2.” They cannot choose to target their unit with the highest Might during this step of finalization.
355.17.	If a spell or ability requires one or more players to make choices that are not outlined in this section, they are made on resolution.

356.	3. Determine Total Cost.
356.1.	Apply base cost modifications in any order.
356.1.a.	If an ability or instruction allows you to play a card "for [Cost]", replace the card's Base Costs with [Cost].
356.1.b.	If an ability or instruction allows you to "ignore" one or more of a card's costs, set the appropriate Base Cost(s) of the card to zero.
356.1.b.1.	If a card allows a player to play a card "ignoring its cost," its base Energy cost and base Power cost are set to zero.
356.1.b.2.	If a card instructs a player to play a card "ignoring its Energy cost" or "ignoring its Power cost," only the appropriate cost is set to zero, and the remaining cost still applies.
356.1.b.3.	Further additional costs and/or cost increases applied in subsequent steps may raise the card's Total Cost above zero. <i>Example:</i> Legion Rearguard is a Fury unit that costs 2 Energy and 0 Power and has Accelerate. A player plays Legion Rearguard and is instructed to ignore its costs, but chooses to pay the Accelerate cost. They ignore Legion Rearguard's Base Cost of 2 Energy, but the optional additional cost of 1 Energy and 1 Fury Power is added to its Total Cost and must be paid.
356.1.c.	Effects that refer to the Base Cost of the card refer to the Printed or Copied Base Cost of said card, and not the modified Base Cost that is used when determining the total cost of the card.
356.2.	Apply additional costs in any order.
356.2.a.	Mandatory Additional Costs
356.2.a.1.	Some Additional Costs specified by Passive Abilities on the card being played or another card are Mandatory, and must be paid to complete playing the card. They use the phrase "as an additional cost" and don't include the word "may." <i>Example:</i> A unit has the passive ability "As an additional cost to play me, kill a friendly unit." To play that unit, a player must kill a friendly unit. See rule 363. Passive Abilities for more information.
356.2.a.2.	The cost imposed by the Deflect keyword is a Mandatory Additional Cost. See rule 809. Deflect for more information.
356.2.b.	Optional Additional Costs
356.2.b.1.	Some Optional Costs specified by Passive Abilities on the card being played or another card are Non-Mandatory, and must be paid only if the player made the choice to pay them in step 2. They use the phrase "as an additional cost" and the word "may." <i>Example:</i> A unit has the ability "As you play me, you may discard 1 as an additional cost. If you do, reduce my cost by [2]." While playing the unit, its controller declares their intention to pay the additional cost in step 2, applies that additional cost in rule 356.2, applies the discount granted by paying that cost in rule 356.4, and discards a card to pay that additional cost in rule 357.2. See rule 363. Passive Abilities for more information.
356.3.	Apply cost increases.

356.4.	Apply discounts.
356.4.a.	Discounts may be applied by the card being played or by any other card or effect.
356.4.b.	Discounts may say that cards "cost [amount] less" or that one or more of their costs are "reduced by [amount]."
356.4.c.	Discounts that only apply to a component of the cost will be applied when that component is added to the cost of the spell and before any other discounts. <i>Example:</i> Ezreal, Prodigy reads "optional additional costs you pay cost [1] or [A] less." When playing a Frigid Touch and choosing to pay the additional cost in step 2, as soon as the additional cost is added to the cost of the spell, Ezreal, Prodigy's discount is applied to it.
356.4.c.1.	Discounts that apply to a given component of a spell's cost may be applied in any order to that component.
356.4.d.	Discounts that apply to the total cost of a spell and not any one component of the cost must be applied after any discount that applies only to a component of the cost.
356.4.d.1.	These discounts may be applied in any order as long as they are applied after component discounts.
356.4.e.	If a discount applies a minimum cost, that minimum applies only to that discount. <i>Example:</i> Eager Apprentice says "While I'm at a battlefield, the Energy costs for spells you play is reduced by [1], to a minimum of [1]." A player who controls Eager Apprentice and a unit with 7 Might plays Sky Splitter, a spell that costs 8 Energy and says "This spell's Energy cost is reduced by the highest Might among units you control." That player can choose to apply Eager Apprentice's discount first, reducing Sky Splitter's Energy cost to 7, then apply Sky Splitter's discount, reducing its Energy cost to 0. If they applied these discounts in the other order, Sky Splitter's Energy cost would be 1.
356.4.f.	Discounts can reduce additional costs, including to 0.
356.4.f.1.	An optional additional cost was "paid" if the player made the decision to pay it. It doesn't matter how much the player actually paid. <i>Example:</i> Clockwork Keeper is a unit that costs 2 Energy and 0 Power and says "As you play me, you may pay [C] as an additional cost. If you do, draw 1." A player controls a card that says "Units you play cost [A] less." That player plays Clockwork Keeper and chooses to pay the optional additional cost of [C]. They will draw a card, even though the optional additional cost was reduced to 0.
356.5.	Apply modifications to the total cost in any order.
356.5.a.	If an effect allows a player to play a card ignoring "any and all costs," set the total cost to [0], including any non-standard costs.
356.6.	Energy and Power costs can't be reduced below 0.
356.7.	Costs may be Energy costs, Power costs, or non-standard costs. <i>Example:</i> A card reads "As an additional cost to play me, kill a friendly unit." Killing a friendly unit is an additional cost to play that card.
357.	4. Pay the card's costs.
357.1.	In total, pay the combined Energy cost (if any) and Power cost (if any).
357.1.a.	During this step, the card's controller can use activated abilities with the Reaction tag that Add resources to add Energy and Power to pay the card's costs. <i>See rule 165. Rune Pools and rule 429. Add for more information.</i>

357.2.	In addition, pay any non-standard Cost summed in step 3 in any order. <i>Example:</i> A card reads in part "As an additional cost to play me, kill a friendly unit and discard a unit." When paying the costs for that card, its controller can pay those two costs in any order; they can kill a friendly unit first and then discard a unit, or they can discard a unit and then kill a friendly unit.
357.2.a.	Costs that are replaced with other events by replacement effects are still considered paid. <i>Example:</i> A player plays Cruel Patron, which says "As an additional cost to play me, kill a friendly unit." They also control Zhonya's Hourglass, which says "If a friendly unit would die, kill this instead. Heal that unit, exhaust it, and recall it." They choose to kill a friendly unit during step 3, but as they pay the cost in step 4, Zhonya's Hourglass replaces that unit's death. The cost is considered paid, and the player can continue playing Cruel Patron.
357.3.	A player may not pay costs during this step that will deterministically result in illegal choices or actions later in this process unless they have no choice. <i>Example:</i> A player plays a card which reads "as an additional cost to play this, you may kill a friendly unit. Give a friendly unit +2 [M] this turn. If you paid the cost, give that unit +7 [M] this turn instead" If they chose to pay the cost, they must choose to kill a unit other than the targeted unit unless they have no choice.
358.	5. Check legality.
358.1.	Check that all chosen targets are legal.
358.2.	Check that all costs were paid.
358.3.	Check that the outcome of the effect of this card being played would not create an illegal state. <i>Example:</i> Check that a spell's execution does not create a state where a Battlefield has Units controlled by 3 different players.
358.3.a.	If a Game Effect prevents the performance of a game action, that effect doesn't prevent cards and abilities that instruct a player to perform that game action from being played or finalized. On resolution, that game action will be skipped as it is an impossible instruction. <i>Example:</i> A player plays Here to Help when their opponent controls a Mageseeker Warden at a battlefield. Here to Help is legal to play under these circumstances. On resolution, no unit will be played.
358.4.	Check that the card has the appropriate permissions to be played at this timing. <i>Example:</i> If the state is Showdown Closed and the card was the one that Closed the state, ensure that it has [Action] or [Reaction]. <i>Example:</i> If the state is Closed and the card wasn't the one that Closed the state, ensure that it has [Reaction].
358.5.	If any of the above checks fail, the actions taken in this process are undone and the action is cancelled.
359.	6. Finish finalizing this card and proceed with the card's category of Play .
359.1.	This card is no longer Pending .
359.2.	A Permanent leaves the Chain and becomes a Game Object .
359.2.a.	Any passive abilities become active.
359.2.b.	Execute all rules text on the card, from top to bottom.
359.2.c.	If it is a Unit , it enters the Board exhausted at the Location that was chosen.
359.2.d.	If it is a Non-Unit Gear , it enters the Board Ready at the player's Base .

359.3.	A Spell lingers on the Chain .
359.3.a.	This card becomes a Finalized Chain Item .
359.3.b.	If there are other Pending Items on the Chain, then the controller of those Pending Items completes Steps 2 through 5 of Playing Cards for those items before continuing. <i>See rule 327. Chains for more information.</i>
359.3.c.	Other players have an opportunity to play Reactions before the resolution of spells. <i>See rule 327. Chains for more information.</i>
359.3.d.	Otherwise, execute the game effect of the spell, from top to bottom of the rules text of the card and then place the card in the Trash of the <i>owning</i> player.
359.3.e.	Handling illegal and impossible instructions
359.3.e.1.	The spell resolves even if some or all of its targets are illegal.
359.3.e.2.	A target is illegal as the spell resolves if it no longer meets the targeting requirements of the spell, or if it has changed Zones to or from a Non-Board Zone .
359.3.e.3.	If a target ceases to meet the targeting requirements while the spell is on the chain, then meets them again, it's a legal target. <i>Example:</i> A spell targets "a unit at a battlefield." A player reacts with a spell that moves the unit to base, then another player reacts with a spell that moves it back to that battlefield, then the original spell resolves. The unit is a legal target.
359.3.e.4.	If a target changes Zones to or from a Non-Board Zone and then returns to its original zone, it is no longer a legal target, because it's not treated as the same object. <i>Examples:</i> An enemy unit at a battlefield is no longer a legal target if it is no longer an enemy, no longer a unit, or no longer at a battlefield. A unit with 3 or less Might is no longer a legal target if it is no longer a unit or if its Might is greater than 3. Something that's exhausted is no longer a legal target if it is no longer exhausted. (It can't stop being "something.")
359.3.e.5.	If any of the spell's targets are no longer legal, those game objects, players, or zones are unaffected by the spell as it resolves. Any instructions related to an illegal target can't be followed. <i>Example:</i> A player plays Void Seeker, a spell that says "Deal 4 to a unit at a battlefield. Draw 1." The unit's controller uses a Reaction to move the unit to their base. Since the unit is no longer a legal target, it is not dealt any damage. Void Seeker's controller still draws 1. <i>Example:</i> A player plays Bellow's Breath targeting a unit in combat that reads in part "I can't be chosen by enemy spells and abilities unless I'm in combat." In reaction, that unit's controller plays Flash, moving the unit to their base. The unit is no longer in combat, so it is no longer a legal target for Bellow's Breath. The unit will be unaffected by Bellow's Breath as it resolves. <i>Example:</i> A player plays Hidden Blade from the facedown zone at a battlefield, targeting an enemy unit. In reaction to Hidden Blade, their opponent plays Tideturner from facedown at another battlefield, choosing to swap locations with the unit Hidden Blade targeted. When Hidden Blade resolves, the chosen unit is no longer at the appropriate battlefield,

		so any instructions related to that unit are ignored.
359.3.e.6.		Instructions that can't be followed, either because of illegal targets or other circumstances, are ignored. <i>Example: A player plays Ride the Wind choosing to move their unit at Vilemaw's Lair to base. Base is a legal move destination for Ride the Wind, but on resolution of Ride the Wind's effect, the move instruction will be ignored because Vilemaw's restriction makes the instruction impossible.</i>
359.3.e.7.		If all of an instruction's Targets become Invalid or Unavailable by the time the spell begins resolving, that instruction will not execute.
359.3.e.8.		If an instruction has more than one Target and fewer than all of the Targets become Invalid or Unavailable by the time the spell begins resolving, the instruction will execute, with only the Targets available and valid being operated on. <i>Example: Singularity reads "deal 6 to each of up to two units." The instruction will execute even if one of those units is made unavailable before the spell begins.</i>
359.3.e.9.		The process for a card's choice becoming Invalid or Unavailable is referred to as mistargeting. <i>Example: A spell has the instruction "Deal 2 to a unit at a battlefield." Before that instruction can execute, the chosen unit is moved to its base. The instruction will <i>not</i> be executed, because it specifies that the unit it chooses must be at a Battlefield, and by the time it attempted to execute, the unit was no longer valid as a choice.</i>
359.3.e.9.a.		If another spell or ability attempts to reference the number of game objects, players, or zones that a Finalized Chain Item targets, it will include any mistargeted choices, but not any targets that have changed to a non-board zone. <i>Example: When a player moves their Volibear, Furious to an occupied enemy battlefield and combat initiates, Volibear's attack trigger goes on the chain targeting three of the units at that battlefield. In reaction, the defending player plays Flash moving two of the three units back. That player cannot then target the attack trigger with Repulse, which reads "Choose a friendly unit at a battlefield. Counter an enemy spell or ability that chooses it and no other friendly unit." If the defending player instead played Heedless Resurrection twice, killing the two units, Repulse can legally target the attack trigger, because two of the targets have changed to a non-board zone.</i>
359.3.e.10.		It is possible for none of a spell's instructions to be executed as it resolves, due to all of them requiring targets to act on and all of those targets becoming Invalid or Unavailable. In this case, the spell has no effect but is still considered played. <i>Example: A player plays a spell that reads "Deal 2 to a unit at a battlefield" with no other instructions, and chooses an enemy unit at a battlefield. They also control a unit with the ability "When you play a spell, give me +1 [M] this turn." Before the spell resolves, the chosen unit is moved to its base. The spell resolves and its only instruction cannot be executed, but the unit's ability still triggers as the spell resolves and gives it +1 [M].</i>
359.3.e.11.		Instructions that can be partially followed are followed as much as possible and ignored otherwise. <i>Example: A player plays a spell that says "Discard 2, then draw 2." If their hand is empty, the instruction to discard 2 will be ignored. They'll still draw 2. If they had 1 card in hand, they would discard it and draw 2.</i>

359.3.e.12.	If the spell checks information about a target that is no longer legal or a card or permanent whose location, zone, or status has changed such that that information is no longer available, that check returns "null" and all calculations based on it are ignored. <i>Examples:</i> A unit that is no longer on the board is treated as having null Might, null cost, etc. A unit that is no longer on the board has no location, is neither exhausted nor readied, etc. Baited Hook says "[1][C], [E]: Kill a friendly unit. Look at the top 5 cards of your Main Deck. You may banish a unit from among them that has Might up to 1 more than the killed unit and play it, ignoring its cost. Then recycle the rest." While Baited Hook's ability is on the chain, an opponent reacts with a spell that returns the friendly unit to its owner's hand. Because the friendly unit is no longer a legal target, it can't be killed and its Might is treated as null. Baited Hook's controller looks at the top 5 cards of their Main Deck, but can't choose any unit from among them. Strike Down reads "Choose an equipped friendly unit. It deals damage equal to its Might to an enemy unit. Then detach an Equipment from it." While Strike Down is on the chain targeting a unit with only one Equipment attached to it, that unit has its Equipment detached via Angle Shot. When Strike Down goes to resolve, the targeted unit is no longer legal, so the unit's Might will return as "null" and the instructions related to it are ignored.
359.3.e.12.a.	If the spell checks information about a target that is legal or a card or permanent whose location, zone, or status has not changed such that information is no longer available, that information is accessible.
359.3.e.13.	A spell or ability that moves something to a different zone as a cost or effect can "look back" at its characteristics before it changes zones.
359.3.e.14.	Some instructions may reference Game Objects affected by, or Game Actions performed in, other instructions in a card. The referenced and referencing instructions are called "linked instructions." <i>Example: Hidden Blade reads "Kill a unit at a battlefield. Its controller draws 2." The "its" in the second instruction references the unit in the first, so the two instructions of the spell are linked.</i>
359.3.e.14.a.	In order for a later linked instruction to execute, its earlier linked instruction must have executed. If the earlier linked instruction is ignored for any reason, the later linked instruction will also be ignored. <i>Example: Hidden Blade reads "Kill a unit at a battlefield. Its controller draws 2." If the chosen unit changes zones or moves to base in reaction to Hidden Blade, the spell will mistarget and the first instruction will be ignored. If the first instruction is ignored, the second instruction will not execute and the unit's controller will not draw 2.</i>
359.3.e.14.b.	If the Game Action performed in an earlier linked instruction is replaced, this will not affect the later linked instruction, unless the later linked instruction directly references the Game Action being performed. <i>Example: Hidden Blade reads "Kill a unit at a battlefield. Its controller draws 2." This effect is split into two instructions: killing the unit and the targeted unit's controller drawing 2. The later linked instruction doesn't reference an action directly, so it will execute even if the kill action of the earlier linked action is</i>

		replaced by some other event. <i>Example:</i> Deathgrip reads “Kill a friendly unit. If you do, give +[M] equal to its Might to another friendly unit this turn.” If the friendly unit in question is not killed by Deathgrip because its death is replaced with another event, the later linked instruction will not execute because “if you do” directly references the game action.
359.3.e.14.c.		Referencing a game action in this way only refers to the game action being performed and the object or player it was performed on, not the circumstances of its performance. <i>Example:</i> A spell reads “Deal 3 to an enemy unit at a battlefield. If you do, heal units you control at the same location as that unit.” If some but not all of that damage is prevented, the later linked instruction will still execute. <i>Example:</i> A spell reads “Banish an enemy unit at a battlefield, then play it to any battlefield. Then if you do, do this: stun all enemy units there.” A player plays it targeting a unit that has a passive replacement effect that reads “I enter in base.” The replacement effect causes the unit to enter in base, but this does not prevent the reflexive trigger of the spell from being placed on the chain. All that matters is that the unit was played.
359.3.e.15.		A spell or ability that leaves the chain during the process of its resolution will cease further execution of its instructions. This immediately causes the spell or ability to finish resolving.
359.3.e.16.		If a Delayed Ability’s duration has ended before it was generated, the Delayed Ability is not generated and any instructions related to it are ignored. <i>Example:</i> Targon’s Peak is a battlefield that reads in part “When you conquer here, ready up to 2 runes at the end of this turn.” If Targon’s Peak is conquered during the Ending Phase after the beginning of the ending step, such as via an effect like thrill of the Hunt, the delayed trigger will not be generated. <i>Example:</i> Akshan, Mischievous reads in part “When you play me, if you paid the additional cost, move an enemy gear to your base. You control it until I leave the board. If it’s an Equipment, attach it to me.” If Akshan leaves the board in reaction to his play effect, the delayed passive ability “You control it until I leave the board,” will not be generated. You will not gain control of the targeted gear even for a moment.
359.3.f.	Referents	
359.3.f.1.		Some information used by abilities is referenced from the source of those abilities, or from one or more targets of a spell or ability. This can usually be recognized by the presence of words like “here,” “my,” or “its.”
359.3.f.2.		Information referenced in an instruction in this way will be checked on execution of the instruction. <i>Examples:</i> A player moves Yasuo, Remorseful to an occupied enemy battlefield and initiates combat there. In reaction to the Yasuo, Remorseful attack trigger, their opponent plays Fight or Flight from hidden targeting Yasuo, moving him back to base. When the attack trigger resolves, “here” is no longer the battlefield where combat is ongoing and the attack trigger mistargets. In reaction to a Yasuo, Remorseful attack trigger, an opponent plays Stupefy targeting Yasuo. When Yasuo’s attack trigger resolves, it will deal

	damage equal to his current Might of 5.
359.3.f.2.a.	When a referent checks information on execution of the instruction related to a target, and that target isn't legal, that referent will return "null" and all instructions related to it will be ignored.
359.3.f.3.	Some information used by triggered abilities is referenced from the trigger condition of the ability. This information is checked when the trigger condition is fulfilled. <i>Example:</i> Lillia, Fae Fawn reads "when I move from a location, play a 3 [M] Sprite token with Temporary there." If Lillia moves to a battlefield, her triggered ability will be placed on the chain and it will note the location she moved from when it does so. If she moves to a non-board zone in reaction to the triggered ability on the chain, it will not affect where the Sprite token will be played when the triggered ability resolves.
359.3.f.3.a.	In the case of a delayed triggered ability, the information is referenced when the triggered ability is created unless specified otherwise.
359.3.f.3.b.	In the case of a linked ability that references information from a linked triggered ability, that information may be referenced from the trigger condition of the linked triggered ability if specified. <i>Example:</i> Iascylla reads "When I hold, at the start of your next Main Phase, you may move an enemy unit to this battlefield." The "this battlefield" in her delayed triggered ability refers to the battlefield she held, and so will be referenced from the trigger condition, when the triggered ability is generated.
359.3.f.4.	Some information used by the effect of a triggered ability is referenced from the triggered ability itself, such as "enemy" and "friendly" status. This information is checked on execution of the referencing instruction. <i>Example:</i> Yasuo, Remorseful reads "when I attack, deal damage equal to my Might to an enemy unit here." Yasuo moves to an occupied enemy battlefield and his attack trigger goes on the chain. In reaction to the attack trigger, the defending player plays a hidden Hostile Takeover and gains control of Yasuo. The triggered ability is unaffected by Yasuo changing controllers, and "enemy" is in reference to the triggered ability itself, so it will resolve with no issue. <i>Example:</i> In reaction to the same Yasuo, Remorseful trigger, say the defending player had instead played a spell that reads "[Reaction]. Gain control of a triggered ability. You may make new choices for it." They chose the attack trigger. When Yasuo's attack trigger resolves, if they didn't make new choices for the trigger, the controller of the triggered ability will no longer be an enemy to the targeted unit, so the triggered ability will mistarget and do nothing. If they instead chose Yasuo with the attack trigger, he would be an enemy unit to the triggered ability and so it would deal damage equal to his Might to himself.
360.	Abilities
361.	An Ability is the structured rules and capabilities of Game Objects or Spells .
361.1.	An Ability has multiple structures. Passive Abilities Replacement Effects Activated Abilities Triggered Abilities Delayed Abilities

362.	A card can have more than one Ability and more than one type of Ability .
363.	Passive Abilities
364.	Conditions, rules, constraints, or statements that affect the course of regular play.
364.1.	These abilities have a wide variety of formats to recognize. <i>Example:</i> "I get +1 [M] while you have 2 or more cards in your hand." <i>Example:</i> "Friendly Yordles at my battlefield have [Shield]."
364.2.	They can be recognized by being statements of fact .
364.3.	Passive Abilities can be conditional.
364.3.a.	Conditional Passive Abilities can be recognized by the occurrence of "if" or "while" as part of the statement of the ability. <i>Example:</i> "While I'm attacking or defending alone, I have +2 [M]." <i>Example:</i> "If an opponent controls a battlefield, I enter ready."
365.	Presence on Permanents
365.1.	Passive Abilities of Permanents are typically only active while on the Board .
366.	Presence on Card outside of the Board
366.1.	Passive Abilities of cards in zones that are outside of the Board will self-describe their context. <i>Example:</i> The passive ability "Play me only during an opponent's turn." applies in any zone from which that card can be played. <i>Example:</i> Undying Legion has a passive ability that reads "[Legion][>] You may play me from your trash for [3][C]." That passive ability only applies when Undying Legion is in the trash.
366.2.	Passive Abilities can alter the costs of cards as they are played.
366.2.a.	These apply at all times in any zone from which the card with the ability can be played.
367.	Replacement Effects
368.	An ability that alters the application of another game effect or game rule.
368.1.	Passive Abilities can be Replacement Effects .
369.	Replacement Effects intercede during the execution of a Game Effect and alter its execution.
369.1.	A Replacement Effect can usually be identified by the presence of the terms "as," "would," or "instead." <i>Example:</i> Zhonya's Hourglass reads "The next time a friendly unit would die, kill this instead. Heal that unit, exhaust it, and recall it." This is a replacement effect that alters the execution of any Game Effect that would kill a friendly unit. <i>Example:</i> Undertitan is a unit that reads in part "As I'm revealed from your deck, [Add] [2]." This is a replacement effect that alters the execution of any Game Effect that reveals Undertitan from your deck.
369.2.	Some Game Actions are themselves Replacement Effects. <i>Example:</i> Burning Out is a replacement effect. <i>Example:</i> Preventing Damage is a replacement effect.
369.3.	Replacement Effects that apply to a unit as it enters the Board can be identified by describing how the unit enters, or by describing a game action that occurs "as" a unit enters.

	<i>Example:</i> Master Yi, Honed reads “I enter ready.” This applies a replacement effect to the way that units normally enter. The event of him entering exhausted is replaced by one where he enters ready. <i>Example:</i> Baron Nashor reads “As you play me, add the Baron Pit battlefield token to the board if it's not there already. If you do, I enter there.” The last sentence of his ability is a replacement effect that replaces the event of him entering at his original play location with him entering at the Baron Pit if it was created.
370.	A Replacement Effect can alter the typical flow of play, including other cards' executions.
370.1.	Replacement Effects apply to any event or instruction that qualifies for their application. A Replacement Effect will specify the circumstances by which an event or instruction will qualify to be replaced.
370.1.a.	An event is the singular moment that results from a Game Action being performed or from a Game Object changing state. <i>Example:</i> The moment that results from a unit being killed is an event that can be referenced by game effects, or even skipped entirely. <i>Example:</i> The moment that results from a unit becoming Mighty is an event that can be referenced by game effects, or even skipped entirely.
370.1.a.1.	Modifying or replacing an event is the same as modifying or replacing that Game Action or change in state that generated that event. <i>Example:</i> Zhonya's Hourglass reads in part “If a friendly unit would die, kill this instead. Heal that unit, exhaust it, and recall it.” A unit's death being replaced by Zhonya's Hourglass is the same as the kill action that caused that death not occurring. <i>Example:</i> A card reads in part “The next time an enemy unit would become Mighty this turn, banish it instead. Its controller plays a 3 [M] Mech unit token to its location.” A unit becoming Mighty being replaced by this effect means the unit never became Mighty—no effects that trigger on units becoming Mighty will trigger.
370.1.a.2.	An event can occur simultaneously with other events only when those events are all the result of the same Game Action or change in state occurring. <i>Example:</i> A spell reads in part “Kill up to two units at battlefields.” When that spell resolves, the units targeted are killed simultaneously because their deaths result from the same game action. <i>Example:</i> A spell reads in part “Kill a friendly unit. If you do, kill an enemy unit with no more Might than it.” When that spell resolves, the units are not killed simultaneously. There are two kill game actions being performed in the instructions of the spell. The friendly unit is killed first, followed by the enemy unit.
370.1.b.	When a Replacement Effect applies, it replaces the qualifying event with one or more Game Actions or events, or the qualifying instruction with another instruction.
370.1.b.1.	In the case of Replacement Effects that describe a game action to occur “as” an event occurs, the described event is replaced by that same event plus the game action being performed. <i>Example:</i> Undertitan is a unit that reads in part “As I'm revealed from your deck, [Add] [2].” The event of Undertitan being revealed from your deck is replaced by Undertitan being revealed from your deck and adding [2] Energy to your Rune Pool.
370.1.c.	Replacement Effects are applied before any qualifying event has actually occurred.

370.2.	A Replacement Effect can only be applied once to an event, or to any Game Actions or events that replace that event. <i>Example:</i> A player plays a spell that reads “gear you control become 1 [M] gear units this turn.” They control two copies of Zhonya’s Hourglass when the spell resolves. If one of those copies is killed, both of their Replacement Effects will be applied. Whichever is applied first, that Replacement Effect can’t be applied again. When it is applied, it kills its source, which creates an event the other can apply its Replacement Effect to. Once they’ve both applied their Replacement Effect to the original death event and the event that replaced it, they cannot go any further. At that point, whichever Zhonya’s Hourglass applied its Replacement Effect last will die.
370.3.	If a Game Object has a Replacement Effect that is active in a specific zone, it is evaluated and subsequently applied if it enters that zone before an event occurs that it could replace. <i>Example:</i> A unit that reads “if a unit you control would die, you may banish me from your trash instead. If you do, heal that unit, exhaust it and recall it.” The first unit dies simultaneously with a 1 [M] Recruit token. It does not enter the trash before the Recruit dies, so it will not be able to replace its death.
370.4.	A Game Object can apply its Replacement Effects to any qualifying events that occur simultaneously with it leaving the zone that its Replacement Effect is active in. <i>Example:</i> Soraka, Wanderer has a Replacement Effect that reads, “If another unit you control here would die, if it has less Might than me, instead heal it, exhaust it, and recall it.” Soraka’s replacement can be applied to any qualifying event that occurs simultaneously with her leaving the board, including to units that die simultaneously with her.
371.	Some Replacement Effects will begin with “once each turn,” or “N times each turn.”
371.1.	These Replacement Effects may only be applied to the specified number of events each turn. Once they have been applied to that many events, they cannot be applied to a later event in the same turn.
371.2.	If the Replacement Effect says a player “may” apply the Replacement Effect , the player has the choice of whether or not to apply it.
371.2.a.	When an event the Replacement Effect could apply to occurs, the player who controls the Replacement Effect may choose to apply it to the event.
371.2.b.	If they do not, it has not been applied this turn. <i>Example:</i> Zilean, Time mage reads “Once each turn, if you would play a token unit while I’m at a battlefield, you may play that token and an additional copy of it instead.” When his controller plays a token, they can choose not to apply the replacement effect to that event. If they do, they can choose to apply it to a later event of a token being played.
372.	If more than one Replacement Effect applies to the same event being executed, then the controller of the object being acted on determines the order the Replacement Effects will apply.
372.1.	If it is a player being acted on, that player decides the order the Replacement Effects will apply.
372.2.	If the affected object is an Uncontrolled Battlefield then the Current Turn Player decides the order the Replacement Effects will apply.
373.	If more than one event occurs simultaneously that Replacement Effects could apply to, each event is treated separately and individually for the purposes of Replacement Effects, and Replacement Effects with the same controller are applied in the order of their controller’s choosing. <i>Example:</i> Two units controlled by the same player die in the same cleanup. That player also controls Zhonya’s Hourglass. They must decide which event to apply Zhonya’s Hourglass to first.
373.1.	Although these events are simultaneous, the applied Replacement Effects are ordered. If multiple applied Replacement Effects with different controllers would execute simultaneously, they execute in turn order.

373.1.a.	When executing Replacement Effects, the Game Actions that comprise their instructions are performed before any simultaneous unmodified events. <i>Example:</i> Two units die simultaneously. One of those units has their death replaced by being healed, exhausted, and recalled. The healing, exhausting, and recalling of that unit will be performed before the other dies.
373.2.	When applying Replacement Effects to events that occur simultaneously, each Replacement Effect may only be applied in one sequence, to any number of events that are qualified to be replaced. <i>Example:</i> Soraka, Wanderer reads "If another unit you control here would die, if it has less Might than me, instead heal it, exhaust it, and recall it." Soraka dies simultaneously with two 1 [M] Recruit tokens at the same battlefield and two 1 [M] Recruit tokens in base. Soraka has a Guardian Angel attached to her when she dies, which appends "If I would die, kill Guardian Angel instead. Heal me, exhaust me, and recall me" to Soraka's rules text. There are several possible ways to order the Replacement Effects being applied to the various events: If Soraka's Replacement Effect is applied first, it saves the Recruits at the same battlefield as her but not the Recruits in base. If the Replacement Effect appended by Guardian Angel then saves Soraka, she cannot apply her Replacement Effect to the Recruits in base as her Replacement Effect has already been applied to an event simultaneous with it dying. If the Replacement Effect appended by Guardian Angel is applied first, it saves Soraka and recalls her - then when Soraka's Replacement Effect is applied, it can only save the Recruits in base.
373.2.a.	A sequence of Replacement Effects is an uninterrupted series of applications to a set of simultaneous events.
373.2.a.1.	A Replacement Effect that replaces an event or Game Action that is part of another Replacement Effect will not interrupt the sequence of the replaced Replacement Effect's application.
374.	A Replacement Effect's controller is the player that controls the source of the Replacement Effect .
375.	If an event that a Replacement Effect applies to would be modified by the Game Effect that generated that event, or the results of that event would be modified by a Game Action from a linked ability that references the replaced event, the Replacement Effect will inherit those modifications. <i>Example:</i> Treasure Hunter reads "When I move, play a Gold gear token exhausted." A Replacement Effect that says "if you would play a token gear, play that token and an additional copy instead" is applied to the event of the Gold gear token being played. The additional copy will also be exhausted, as it inherits the "exhausted" modification. <i>Example:</i> Another Replacement Effect says "if you would play a token, draw 1 instead." The modification from Treasure Hunter's ability cannot apply, so we ignore it. <i>Example:</i> A spell reads "play a ready 3 [M] Mech token. Then do this: Give it Temporary." A Replacement Effect that says "if you would play a unit token, play that token and a 1 [M] Recruit token instead" is applied to the event of the Mech token being made. The Recruit token enters ready and is given Temporary.
376.	Activated Abilities
377.	Activated Abilities are repeatable effects with a cost. They follow a process of going onto the chain and resolving, similar to Playing a Card. See rule 349. Playing Cards for more information.
377.1.	Activated Abilities are recognized by the presence of a ":" in the text of the card, preceded by a cost and succeeded by an effect. <i>Example:</i> "[2]: Draw 1" is an activated ability. The cost is 2 energy. The effect is to draw 1 card.
377.2.	Card text will refer to activating Activated Abilities with the word "use" or "play."
377.2.a.	If "using" or "playing" an Activated Ability is part of a trigger condition, that condition is fulfilled when the Activated Ability resolves.

377.2.b.	If an Activated Ability has a condition on “using” or “playing” it, that condition must be true in order to activate the ability in question. <i>Example:</i> Ultrasoft Poro reads “[E]: Play two 1 [M] Bird unit tokens with [Deflect]. Use this ability only while I'm at a battlefield.” In order to activate the ability, Ultrasoft Poro must be located at a battlefield.
377.3.	Activated Abilities use the chain.
377.3.a.	Declare activation of the Ability .
377.3.a.1.	The ability goes on the chain but has no card to represent it, so players need to take note that it is now a Closed State .
377.3.b.	Proceed with executing the Chain .
377.3.b.1.	Follow the steps of “Playing or Activating Abilities” in rule 398 . This ability will become a Pending Chain Item .
377.3.b.2.	Opponents have an opportunity to respond, as appropriate, as if a card was played onto the chain.
377.3.b.3.	If no further action is taken, execute the Activated Ability .
378.	The controlling player chooses when and whether to activate an Activated Ability .
379.	Activated abilities are present on Game Objects and some Spells .
380.	Can primarily be activated while on the Board .
381.	All Activated Abilities can only be activated on the <i>Controlling Player's Turn</i> and during an Open State .
382.	Triggered Abilities
383.	Triggered Abilities are repeatable effects that happen when a Condition is met.
383.1.	Triggered Abilities can usually be recognized by the word “when” followed by a game action or event; the word “at” followed by a point in time during the turn sequence; or the phrase “the [Nth] time” followed by a game action or event. <i>Examples:</i> “When you conquer here, you may spend a buff to draw 1.” “At the end of your turn, ready 2 runes.” “The <i>first time</i> I move each turn, you may ready something else that's exhausted.”
383.1.a.	The phrases that identify triggered abilities do not always appear at the beginning of sentences or abilities.
383.1.b.	If an ability triggers “the [Nth] time” something happens and that trigger condition is met multiple times simultaneously, the ability's controller picks one of those instances to serve as the trigger condition. The ability triggers only once, due to the chosen condition. <i>Example:</i> Wraith of Echoes reads “The first time another friendly unit dies each turn, draw 1.” That ability hasn't triggered yet this turn. Two other friendly units die simultaneously (say, due to combat damage). The Wraith's controller chooses one of those deaths to trigger Wraith's ability.
383.2.	Triggered Abilities have a Condition and an Effect .
383.2.a.	The Condition is the clause with When, At, or the Nth Time .
383.2.a.1.	Any additional conditional statement immediately after the Condition must be true in order for the Condition to be fulfilled. Such a conditional statement is part of

	the Trigger Condition and not the Effect. <i>Example:</i> Sona, Harmonious reads “At the end of your turn, if I’m at a battlefield, ready up to 4 friendly runes.” Her Trigger Ability’s Condition will be fulfilled in the Ending Step, but the Triggered Ability will only be placed on the chain if she is located at a battlefield when the Condition is fulfilled. If she is removed in reaction to the triggered ability, it will still resolve. <i>Example:</i> Loose Cannon reads “At the start of your Beginning Phase, draw 1 if you have one or fewer cards in your hand.” The “if you have one or fewer cards in your hand” conditional statement is not immediately after the trigger condition, so it is part of the effect and not the condition.
383.2.b.	The Effect is the Instructions that are not part of the Condition .
383.2.c.	The Condition of a Trigger is evaluated after a potentially inciting event has been processed.
383.2.c.1.	If a Game Object has a Triggered Ability that is active in a specific zone, it is evaluated and subsequently triggered if it enters that zone at the same time that its Trigger’s condition is met. <i>Example:</i> Immortal Phoenix says “When you kill a unit with a spell, you may pay [1][C] to play me from your trash.” This ability triggers if Immortal Phoenix is in your trash immediately after you kill a unit with a spell, even if the unit you killed with a spell was that Immortal Phoenix.
383.2.c.2.	A Game Object will not be able to successfully evaluate its Trigger Condition, however, if it leaves the zone that its Trigger is active from at the same time that its Trigger is satisfied. <i>Example:</i> Viktor, Leader says “When another non-Recruit unit you control dies, play a 1 [M] Recruit unit token into your base.” This ability triggers if Viktor is on the board immediately after another non-Recruit unit you control dies. It does <i>not</i> trigger if Viktor and another non-Recruit unit you control die during the same game action (for instance, if they are both killed in the same Cleanup due to the damage dealt by Unchecked Power).
383.3.	When a Condition is met, a Triggered Ability behaves like an Activated Ability and is placed on the Chain .
383.3.a.	If a Triggered Ability says “you may” or “they may” as the first part of its Effect, the controller of its source will choose whether or not to perform the Triggered Ability during finalization. <i>Example:</i> Tideturner reads “When you play me, you may choose a unit you control at another location. Move me to its location and it to my original location.” This “you may” appears as the first part of its effect, so the choice represents whether or not to perform the triggered ability.
383.3.a.1.	The decision of “may” when it appears in this way is solely whether or not to perform said triggered ability.
383.3.a.2.	If the controller of the Triggered Ability chooses not to perform that Triggered Ability during finalization, it is removed from the chain and considered to have not triggered.
383.3.a.3.	If “you may” or “they may” appears in any later part of the Effect of a triggered ability, it is decided on resolution. <i>Example:</i> Ornn, Blacksmith reads “When you play me or when I hold, look at the top 4 cards of your Main Deck. You may reveal a gear from among them and draw it. Then recycle the rest.” This “you may” does not appear as the first part of its effect, so the choice is made on resolution. The ability is always finalized to the chain.
383.3.b.	If a Triggered Ability contains a cost within instructions at the beginning of the effect or

	immediately following the “you may” or “they may” that appears as the first part of the effect, that cost is treated as the base cost of the Triggered Ability. <i>Example:</i> Ekko, Recurrent reads “[Deathknell][>] Recycle me to ready your runes.” In this case, “recycle me to ready your runes” is a cost within instructions that appears at the beginning of the effect of the ability, and thus “recycle me” is taken as the base cost of the triggered ability. <i>Example:</i> Insightful Investigator reads “When you play me, choose an opponent. They reveal their hand. You may pay 2 XP to choose a card from their hand. If you do, they discard that card and draw 1.” The “pay 2 XP” is a cost within instructions, but because it does not appear in the first part of the effect, it is not taken as the base cost of the triggered ability. Paying 2 XP is performed on resolution.
383.3.b.1.	The cost must be paid in order to finalize the Triggered Ability to the Chain .
383.3.c.	Triggered Abilities can be put on the Chain during Closed States or Open States on any player's turn.
383.3.d.	If more than one Triggered Ability is Triggered simultaneously, then the player that controls the Abilities selects the order to place them on the Chain .
383.3.d.1.	If multiple players separately control Triggered Abilities that are Triggered simultaneously, then starting with the Turn Player and proceeding in Turn Order , each player orders their Triggered Abilities on the Chain .
383.3.e.	Some Triggered Abilities will trigger “once each turn,” or “N times each turn.”
383.3.e.1.	Such a Triggered Ability will only be performed the specified number of times each turn. If its trigger condition would be fulfilled and it has already been performed that many times, it does not trigger.
383.3.e.2.	If the Triggered Ability says “you may” or “they may” as the first part of its effect, its controller has the choice of whether or not it is performed.
383.3.e.2.a.	During finalization of the Triggered Ability , the player who controls the Triggered Ability may choose to perform it.
383.3.e.2.b.	If they do not, it is removed from the chain. <i>Example:</i> A player controls a unit that reads in part “Once each turn, when an enemy unit dies, you may banish it.” When an enemy Recruit token dies, the triggered ability goes on the chain. If they choose not to perform the ability on finalization, it is removed from the chain. When a Stalwart Poro dies later in the turn, they can choose to trigger it then.
383.4.	Some Conditions are commonly used and structured in a way that explicitly defines their use and other properties of the Effect that is associated with it.
383.4.a.	Play Effects are Triggered Abilities whose Condition includes the Permanent that has the Play Effect being played to the board.
383.4.a.1.	These are commonly structured as “When you play me...” for Units and “When you play this...” for Gear .
383.4.a.2.	These Triggered Abilities are put on the Chain as Pending Items after the Permanent these effects correspond to is finalized and enters the board.
383.4.a.3.	These Triggered Abilities can be referred to as Play Effects.
383.4.a.4.	Abilities that trigger when another object is played are not considered Play Effects.

383.4.b.	Targeting Effects are Triggered Abilities whose Condition includes a Game Object becoming targeted.
383.4.b.1.	These are commonly structured as “When you choose me ...” or “When you choose a [Game Object] ...”
383.4.b.2.	These Triggered Abilities are put on the Chain as Pending Items after a spell or ability that targets an appropriate Game Object is Finalized .
383.4.b.3.	Although these abilities say “choose” in their Condition , they trigger specifically when an appropriate Game Object is Targeted . <i>See rule 355.6. Targeting for more information on what counts as Targeting.</i>
383.4.b.4.	These Triggered Abilities can be referred to as Targeting Effects .
383.4.c.	Conquer Effects are Triggered Abilities whose Condition includes a Unit participating in, and successfully Conquering a Battlefield .
383.4.c.1.	These are commonly structured as “When I conquer...” and “When you conquer...”
383.4.c.2.	This category of Triggered Abilities encompasses only those that are triggered from Units that were present during the Conquer action, or Abilities that reference the player that performed the Conquer action.
383.4.c.2.a.	The Conquer Abilities of Units are put on the Chain as Pending Items after the Unit(s) these effects correspond to are present at a Battlefield when a player gains control of it and gains 1 Victory Point from Conquering .
383.4.c.2.b.	The Conquer Abilities of anything that references the player Conquering is put on the Chain as a Pending Item when the Condition that the player that controls the triggering source has performed a Conquer and gained 1 Victory Point.
383.4.c.2.c.	If the act of gaining one point from Conquering is negated or replaced in any way, the Conquer Effect will still trigger.
383.4.c.3.	These Triggered Abilities can be referred to as Conquer Effects.
383.4.d.	Hold Effects are Triggered Abilities whose Condition includes a Unit being present at a Battlefield during the Beginning phase when a player scores Victory Points from Holding .
383.4.d.1.	These are commonly structured as “When I hold...” or “When you hold...”
383.4.d.2.	This category of Triggered Abilities encompasses only those that are triggered from Units that were present during the Hold action, or Abilities that reference the player that performed the Hold action.
383.4.d.2.a.	The Hold Abilities of Units are put on the Chain as Pending Items after the Unit these effects correspond to are present at a Battlefield when a player maintains control of it and Gains 1 Victory Point during their Beginning Phase from Holding .
383.4.d.2.b.	The Hold Abilities of anything that references the player Holding is put on the Chain as a Pending Item when the Condition that the player that controls the triggering source has performed a Hold and gained 1 Victory Point.
383.4.d.2.c.	If the act of gaining one point from Holding is negated or replaced in any way, the Hold Effect will still trigger.

383.4.d.3.	These Triggered Abilities can be referred to as Hold Effects.
383.4.e.	Attack Triggers are Triggered Abilities that trigger when a Unit or Player gains the Attacker designation for the first time during a combat.
383.4.e.1.	These are commonly structured as “When I attack...” or “When you attack...”
383.4.e.2.	These Triggered Abilities are put on the Chain as Pending Items after the Unit these effects correspond to gains the Attacker designation during Combat .
383.4.e.2.a.	These triggers will only have their condition checked once per combat, despite a Unit being able to gain and lose the Attacker designation multiple times in the same combat.
383.4.e.2.b.	If the trigger condition contains other requirements besides attacking and if those requirements are not fulfilled when the unit gains the Attacker designation, it will not trigger in that combat.
383.4.e.3.	These Triggered Abilities can be referred to as Attack Triggers.
383.4.f.	Defend Triggers are Triggered Abilities that trigger when a Unit or Player gains the Defender designation for the first time during a combat.
383.4.f.1.	These are commonly structured as “When I defend...” or “When you defend...”
383.4.f.2.	These Triggered Abilities are put on the Chain as Pending Items after the Unit these effects correspond to gains the Defender designation during Combat .
383.4.f.2.a.	These triggers will only have their condition checked once per combat, despite a Unit being able to gain and lose the Defender designation multiple times in the same combat.
383.4.f.2.b.	If the trigger condition contains other requirements besides defending and if those requirements are not fulfilled when the unit gains the Defender designation, it will not trigger in that combat.
383.4.f.3.	These Triggered Abilities can be referred to as Defend Triggers.
383.4.g.	Some effects may instruct a player to “activate” one of these named triggered abilities.
383.4.g.1.	To do so, that player checks the condition of all of the specified effects, as if they had fulfilled the named part of the condition. <i>Example:</i> Reckoner’s Arena reads “When you hold here, activate the conquer effects of units here.” For each unit at the battlefield, you will check the trigger condition of their conquer effects to see if the condition has been fulfilled, treating the conquer portion of the condition as having been fulfilled. If all of the conditions are fulfilled for a conquer effect, it is placed on the chain as if it had just triggered. If any of the non-conquer parts of the condition are not fulfilled, it will not be placed on the chain. <i>Example:</i> A spell reads “Activate the play effects of your gear.” For each gear you control, you will treat it as if you had just played the gear and check the other conditions of that gear. If all of the conditions are fulfilled for a play effect, it is placed on the chain as if it had just triggered.
384.	Presence on Permanents
384.1.	Typically active while on the Board .
384.2.	Triggered Abilities of Permanents are only able to have their Conditions evaluated while on the Board .

385.	Presence on Cards outside of the Board
385.1.	Triggered Abilities on cards outside of the Board rely on the Information Level of the zone they are in.
385.2.	Triggered Abilities outside of the Board will self-describe their context. <i>Example:</i> The triggered ability "When you conquer, you may discard 1 to return this from your trash to your hand." triggers while the card it's on is in the trash, and not anywhere else.
386.	Reflexive Triggers
387.	Reflexive Triggers are a type of Triggered Ability that create one or more Chain Items when their condition is met.
387.1.	Reflexive Triggers can be recognized by the phrase "Do this:" or "Do one of the following:".
387.1.a.	"Do this" can be followed by "N times." The Reflexive Trigger will thus be added to the chain N times when its condition is met.
387.1.b.	"Do one of the following" can instead be "Do X of the following" or "Do the following". The effect will specify which of the related Reflexive Triggers will go on the chain when the condition is met.
387.2.	Reflexive Triggers will be preceded by their conditions, if any. If no condition is present in the ability then the Reflexive Trigger will always be added to the Chain.
387.3.	If present, the Condition of a Reflexive Trigger will follow the same format as a Triggered Ability .
388.	Reflexive Triggers use the Chain.
388.1.	A new ability is created and added to the chain as a Pending Item . <i>See rule 398. Playing or Activating Abilities for more information.</i>
388.2.	If a Reflexive Trigger creates more than one Pending Item it creates them all in order, but does not go beyond the first step of adding them to the Chain. <i>See rule 398. Playing or Activating Abilities for more information.</i>
389.	Delayed Abilities
390.	Delayed Abilities are a type of Ability that specifies a window of applicability during which they are active.
390.1.	Delayed Abilities can be any other type of Ability , and contain all of the properties of that type in addition to the properties of Delayed Abilities .
390.2.	Delayed Triggers are Triggered Abilities that can be recognized by describing a specific time of the turn, or by structuring a Triggered Ability with a specific frame of time as a restriction.
390.3.	Delayed Replacements are Replacement Effects that can be recognized by specifying the effect they are replacing at a specific time, or "the [Nth] time" in the description of the effect as it resolves.
390.3.a.	Some Delayed Replacements take the form "then recycle it," or "then banish it," in reference to chain items being played by linked abilities or instructions. These are short for "if it would leave the chain after becoming a finalized chain item, and leaving the chain wasn't instructed by its own execution, perform the specified game action instead."
390.4.	Delayed Passive Abilities are Passive Abilities that are applicable only during a specified window of time. The time that the Delayed Passive Ability applies will be recognized in the effect that initiates it.
390.5.	Delayed Linked Abilities are Linked Abilities that are generated by another Ability and reference that Ability or Game Objects it affects instead of a window of time.